

Slip Box

Vault Documentation

June 2026

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Master Guide

Slip Box — Master Guide

Use, Maintenance & Troubleshooting · Updated June 8, 2026

Part 1: What this vault is

The Slip Box is a personal operating system built around three tools — **Obsidian** (knowledge, reflection, reviews), **Todoist** (task management), and **Morgen Calendar** (scheduling). Each tool has a distinct lane; overlap is where friction comes from.

Tool	Owns	Does not own
Slip Box vault	Daily intention, habit tracking, focus logging, vitals, quest management, weekly/monthly/quarterly reviews, knowledge and thinking (Zettelkasten)	Task management with reminders, scheduling, calendar events
Todoist	All actionable tasks — work and personal — with due dates; quick capture from anywhere; recurring tasks; reminders	Reflection, knowledge, long-form thinking
Morgen Calendar	All time-bound events; time-blocking for focused work; the daily and weekly schedule view	Task management, reflection, note-taking

The vault is the anchor — open it every day. Morning order: **Morgen → Todoist → Obsidian**. Never reversed — checking the vault before looking at the calendar produces intentions that ignore reality.

The vault operates in three layers:

The doing layer answers: *What am I working on and am I making progress?*

Quests set 90-day goals. Daily notes track focus, tasks, and health vitals. Reviews close the feedback loop — weekly, monthly, quarterly.

The thinking layer answers: *What do I actually know and believe?*

The Zettelkasten (`06-Zettelkasten`) builds a networked body of ideas. Every book,

article, and insight captured becomes a permanent note that links to others. The network grows more valuable with every addition.

The health layer answers: *How is my body doing over time?*

Vitals are logged in each daily note and aggregated automatically — daily log, weekly averages, monthly averages, and quarterly trends — all from the dashboard.

The layers connect: ideas in the thinking layer generate quests in the doing layer; vitals trends inform the Health & energy life area in every review; quests produce experiences that generate new permanent notes.

The five core questions

Everything in the vault traces back to these:

1. **Who am I and what do I want?** → 01-Vision (Life Compass + Future Vision)
2. **What am I actively working toward?** → 02-Quests
3. **Am I making progress?** → 03-Reviews + 04-Daily-Notes
4. **What do I think and know?** → 06-Zettelkasten
5. **How is my body doing?** → Vitals tracker (daily notes + vitals.base)

Part 2: Vault structure

Slip Box/	~460 notes · as of June 8, 2026
├─ .obsidian/	Obsidian configuration – do not edit manually
├─ _attachments/	PDFs and binary files – drag-and-drop saves here automatically
├─ Attachment Catalog.md	Master index – add a row every time you add a file
└─ Work/Automation/	10 Rockwell PDF manuals with companion notes
├─ _archive/	Completed/outdated material
├─ Fleeting/	Processed fleeting notes tagged `processed`
├─ Daily-Notes/	Daily notes older than 90 days (batch-move quarterly)
└─ Quests/	Completed or abandoned quests
├─ _docs/	System documentation – click folder to open navigation hub
├─ _docs.md	Navigation hub – start here for any system question
├─ Slip Box Master Guide.md	(this document)
├─ Getting Started - First 30 Days.md	
└─ Vault State - June 2026.md	

- | └─ Vault Backup System.md
- | └─ Commander – Quick Reference.md
- | └─ Bulk Import Work Reference PDFs.md
- | └─ Life Compass – Complete Procedure.md
- | └─ Zettelkasten – Complete Procedure.md
- | └─ Vault Systems – Complete Procedure.md
- | └─ Evaluations/ Audit history – 14 evaluations (May-June 2026)
- └─ _reference/ Reference material – looked up, not Zettelkasten-processed
- | └─ Personal/ DMV, insurance, vehicle, home hunting (10 notes)
- | └─ Work/ Process docs, SOPs
- └─ _scripts/ QuickAdd macros + Templater scripts
- | └─ weekly-calendar.js Fetches Google Calendar ICS → Weekly Calendar.md (Ctrl+Shift+K)
- | └─ next-week-calendar.js Fetches next week ICS → Next Week Calendar.md (Ctrl+Shift+J)
- | └─ daily-schedule.js Templater user script – populates today's schedule in daily notes
- | └─ vault-backup.bat Git commit + push to GitHub (run manually or via Task Scheduler)
- └─ _templates/ 18 note templates – do not write notes here
- └─ 00-Home/ Dashboard and base views only
- └─ 01-Vision/ Life Compass and Future Vision
- └─ 02-Quests/ Active quests – Health Reset Q3 + New Role Integration Q3
- └─ 03-Reviews/
- | └─ Weekly/ W20-W23 (2026) – auto-created via Periodic Notes (Ctrl+Shift+W)
- | └─ Monthly/ May 2026, June 2026
- | └─ Quarterly/ Q2 2026 review
- └─ 04-Daily-Notes/ May 21 – Jun 8, 2026 · schedule auto-populates on creation
- └─ 05-Resources/
- | └─ Articles/ Articles to read / reading / done
- | └─ Books/ 32 book notes – reading tracker, linked to Literature notes
- | └─ Courses/
- | └─ └─ HAM-Radio/ General License study system – started Jun 8, 2026

```

| | | — GPS-Tracker-Project/ Paul McWhorter Raspberry Pi series
| | |   └─ MIT-CS/           MIT OpenCourseWare notes
| |   └─ Ideas/             Project-shaped sparks; pipeline to quests
└─ 06-Zettelkasten/
|   └─ Fleeting/           ~150 notes – processing queue active (10/week target)
|   └─ Literature/         49 notes – includes 11 IA/OT reference stubs (June 2026)
|   └─ Permanent/         28 notes – 6 original + 22 IA/OT domain stubs (June
2026)
|   └─ MOC/               4 Maps of Content:
|                           · Automation Engineering MOC
|                           · HAM Radio MOC
|                           · PKM and Zettelkasten MOC
|                           · Personal Growth MOC
|                           · MOC – Instrumentation
|                           · MOC – OT Networking
|                           · MOC – PLC Architecture
|                           · MOC – Process Safety (IEC 61511)
└─ 07-Work-Knowledge/     38 notes – professional knowledge + CAP prep
    └─ Automation/        12 notes – full electrical fundamentals sequence
    └─ Networking/        9 notes – OT/IT, Windows Server, Linux, AWS
    └─ Processes/         10 notes – pharma manufacturing, SOPs, documentation
    └─ Troubleshooting/   2 notes
    └─ CAP-Certification/  2 notes – domain breakdown and study timeline

```

Files in 00-Home

`00-Home` is **operational only** — the dashboard and its base views. All system documentation lives in `_docs/`.

File	Purpose
<code>00-Home.md</code>	The dashboard — open this every day
<code>quests.base</code>	Powers the Active Quests section
<code>focus-log.base</code>	Powers the Focus log chart
<code>reading-list.base</code>	Powers the Currently Reading section
<code>zettelkasten.base</code>	Powers the Recent Permanent Notes section
<code>daily-focus.base</code>	Morning intention vs. end-of-day tracker

File	Purpose
<code>vitals.base</code>	Powers the Vitals Tracker
<code>weekly-reviews.base</code>	Powers the Recent Weekly Reviews section
<code>monthly-reviews.base</code>	Powers the Recent Monthly Reviews section
<code>quarterly-reviews.base</code>	Powers the Recent Quarterly Reviews section
<code>Weekly Calendar.md</code>	Generated by <code>Ctrl+Shift+K</code> — current week from Google Calendar
<code>Next Week Calendar.md</code>	Generated by <code>Ctrl+Shift+J</code> — next week from Google Calendar

Files in `_docs`

File	Purpose
<code>_docs.md</code>	Navigation hub — single entry point for all system documentation
<code>Slip Box Master Guide.md</code>	This document — full reference
<code>Getting Started - First 30 Days.md</code>	Onboarding checklist
<code>Vault State - June 2026.md</code>	Monthly health check + quarterly audit queries — run this monthly
<code>Vault Backup System.md</code>	Backup architecture, setup, and restore procedures
<code>Commander – Quick Reference.md</code>	Toolbar/Ribbon/Tab Bar button reference + troubleshooting
<code>Bulk Import Work Reference PDFs.md</code>	Procedure for bulk-importing vendor PDFs
<code>Life Compass – Complete Procedure.md</code>	Step-by-step guide: values, roles, energy audit, quarterly review
<code>Zettelkasten – Complete Procedure.md</code>	Step-by-step guide: all 4 note types, processing, linking, MOCs
<code>Vault Systems – Complete Procedure.md</code>	Step-by-step guide: daily notes, vitals, reviews, quests, backup

File	Purpose
Evaluations/	Audit history — 14 evaluations (May-June 2026)

Part 3: Three-tool system

What each tool owns

Tool	Owns	Does not own
Slip Box vault	Intention, reflection, quests, reviews, knowledge, vitals, Zettelkasten	Task reminders, scheduling, calendar events
Todoist	All actionable tasks with due dates; recurring tasks; inbox capture	Reflection, knowledge, long-form thinking
Morgen Calendar	Time-bound events; time-blocking; the daily schedule view	Task management, reflection, note-taking

Connection points

Morgen Calendar ↔ Todoist

Shows time-bound events + Todoist tasks together

Time-block Todoist priorities in Morgen

Todoist ↔ Slip Box vault

Quest milestones → Todoist tasks with due dates

Todoist inbox captures → vault if insight, stay in Todoist if task

Weekly review quest progress → informs Todoist task rescheduling

Morgen Calendar ↔ Slip Box vault

Ctrl+Shift+K / J → live Google Calendar view inside Obsidian

Calendar shape → informs daily note focus_intention

Next week's calendar → informs weekly review Section 7

Todoist quick links

Project	What lives here	Link
Inbox	Unprocessed captures — process to zero every Sunday	todoist://inbox
Work	Work Admin, Professional Development, OT System, Troubleshooting	todoist://project?id=6gj9XJ56ccgp93vg
Personal	House, Finances, Medical, Insurance, Pets, Travel, Admin	todoist://project?id=6gj9XJ2wWPr4vHxG
LifeOS Learning	System-building tasks — Life Compass, Quests setup, vault work	todoist://project?id=6gmgpP4Cp8R8wCGh
Work Backlog	Work tasks not ready to action yet	todoist://project?id=6gjPGQG8PWJhWRWh
Personal Backlog	Personal tasks not ready to action yet	todoist://project?id=6gjPGJRHRmMgcmRcM

Capture routing

Type	Where it goes
Work task	Todoist → Work project (or Inbox on the go)
Personal task / errand	Todoist → Personal project (or Inbox)
Thought / insight	<code>Ctrl+Shift+C</code> → Obsidian daily capture (no context switch)
Fleeting idea needing its own note	<code>Ctrl+Shift+F</code> → Obsidian Fleeting folder
Quest-related action	Quest note: <code>- [] Action ▢ YYYY-MM-DD</code>
Meeting to schedule	Morgen Calendar directly

Calendar scripts

All three calendar scripts share the same Google Calendar ICS URL stored in QuickAdd settings (Settings → QuickAdd → Manage Macros → ⚙ → `ics_url` field).

Script	Trigger	Writes to
<code>_scripts/weekly-calendar.js</code>	<code>Ctrl+Shift+K</code>	<code>00-Home/Weekly Calendar.md</code>
<code>_scripts/next-week-calendar.js</code>	<code>Ctrl+Shift+J</code>	<code>00-Home/Next Week Calendar.md</code>
<code>_scripts/daily-schedule.js</code>	Templater (auto on daily note creation)	<code>### ▢ Today's schedule</code> section

If the schedule section shows `⚠ No calendar ICS URL found`, open QuickAdd → Manage Macros → Weekly Calendar → ⚙ and verify the `ics_url` field is populated.

Part 4: Plugin reference

Community plugins (15 installed)

Plugin	Role
Templater	Auto-applies templates when notes are created in configured folders
Dataview	Powers live tables, progress bars, and lists in reviews and Zettelkasten
Calendar	Sidebar calendar for navigating daily/periodic notes
Periodic Notes	Creates weekly/monthly/quarterly review notes in the right folders
Tasks	Scans all notes for <code>▢ YYYY-MM-DD</code> due-date tasks
QuickAdd	Hotkey capture, new note macros, calendar fetch macros
Advanced URI	Powers all clickable action links in the dashboard
Homepage	Opens the dashboard automatically on startup
Commander	Adds custom buttons to the Ribbon, Tab Bar, and note Toolbar
Folder Notes	Makes folder names clickable — opens their index note
Notebook Navigator	Clean folder panel view
Linters	Auto-normalizes frontmatter on save (templates folder excluded; <code>force-yaml-escape: OFF</code>)

Plugin	Role
Note Refactor	Extract selected text to a new note
Heatmap Calendar	Focus time streak visualization on dashboard
Minimal Theme Settings	Controls for Minimal theme appearance

Core plugins (must stay enabled)

Plugin	Role
Bases	Powers all <code>.base</code> embedded views throughout the vault
Graph	Visualizes connections between notes
Backlinks	Shows what links to the current note
Properties	Renders frontmatter as a structured panel
Search	Full-text search across the vault

Part 5: Hotkey reference

Action	Hotkey	Notes
Open today's daily note	<code>Ctrl+D</code>	Creates it if it doesn't exist
Open this week's review	<code>Ctrl+Shift+W</code>	Creates it if it doesn't exist
Open dashboard	<code>Ctrl+H</code>	Goes to <code>00-Home/00-Home.md</code>
New fleeting note	<code>Ctrl+Shift+F</code>	Creates in <code>06-Zettelkasten/Fleeting/</code>
New permanent note	<code>Ctrl+Shift+P</code>	Creates in <code>06-Zettelkasten/Permanent/</code> — rename immediately
Add to daily capture	<code>Ctrl+Shift+C</code>	Appends to today's daily note without opening it
Fetch weekly calendar	<code>Ctrl+Shift+K</code>	Writes to <code>00-Home/Weekly Calendar.md</code>
	<code>Ctrl+Shift+J</code>	Writes to <code>00-Home/Next Week Calendar.md</code>

Action	Hotkey	Notes
Fetch next week calendar		
Extract to new note	Ctrl+Shift+E	Note Refactor — splits selected text
Open graph view	Ctrl+G	Color-coded by note type

Part 6: Daily workflow

The morning sequence runs across three tools in a fixed order. Don't reverse it.

Morning (15 minutes)

Step 1 — Morgen Calendar (3 min)

Open Morgen or press `Ctrl+Shift+K` to pull this week's calendar into the vault. See today's shape — meetings, blocks, real available time — before touching Todoist or the vault.

Step 2 — Todoist Today view (5 min) — [todoist://today](https://todoist.com/today)

With the calendar shape visible: are today's tasks realistic? Process overnight inbox. Reschedule anything that won't happen. Identify your 1-2 most important tasks. Daily goal: 5 completed tasks.

Step 3 — Obsidian daily note (5 min) — `Ctrl+D`

- **Today's schedule** — auto-populates from Google Calendar on note creation
- **Today's focus** — one sentence in `focus_intention:` (Properties panel)
- **Quest habits** — which Health Reset habits will you do today? Commit now
- **Morning vitals** — BP, pulse, glucose, weight
- Scan the **Tasks** query — vault tasks due today?

Step 4 — Morgen time-block (2 min) — block protected focus time now.

Logging focus sessions

In the Focus Log section of the daily note, log in **minutes**:

- ```
- [duration:: 90] OT System — network documentation
- [duration:: 45] HAM Radio study — G1 Commission's Rules
```

The `Total today:` line sums automatically. Copy the total to `focus_minutes:` in frontmatter at end of day.

*Quick reference: 30 min = 30 · 1 hr = 60 · 90 min = 90 · 2 hr = 120*

## End of day (8 minutes)

1. **Morgen (2 min):** Check tomorrow's calendar. Create focus blocks for tomorrow's priorities.
  2. **Todoist (3 min):** Reschedule undone tasks. Process inbox. Confirm tomorrow's list.
  3. **Obsidian daily note (3 min):**
  4. Enter steps, weight, energy (1-5) in Properties
  5. Sum focus sessions → copy total to `focus_minutes:` frontmatter
  6. Write one sentence in `end_of_day:` — what actually happened?
  7. Check any habit boxes done but not yet checked
- 

## Part 7: Weekly workflow — Sunday (~50 minutes)

Do Todoist and Morgen **before** opening the vault.

### Step 1 — Todoist (10 min)

Inbox to zero. Overdue review — no task stays overdue more than one week. Confirm next week's top 5-7 tasks have due dates. Check backlogs.

### Step 2 — Morgen Calendar (5 min)

Open `ctrl+shift+j` to pull next week's calendar. Time-block the Todoist priorities. Resolve conflicts now.

### Step 3 — Obsidian weekly review (25 min) — `ctrl+shift+w`

**Section 1 — Clear the decks:** The Todoist + Morgen work just done counts here.

**Section 2 — Life area check-in:** Rate 6 areas 1-5. Vitals Dataview table auto-shows this week's health data. Copy overall rating to `rating:` frontmatter.

**Section 3 — Focus hours:** Fully automatic. Dataview pulls `focus_minutes` from each daily note. DataviewJS totals them, shows a progress bar against the 1,200 min target, and prompts you to copy the total to `focus_minutes:` frontmatter.

**Section 4 — Three wins:** Open `daily-focus.base` on "Last 7 days" view — morning intentions are there to jog memory.

**Section 5 — Quest progress:** Dataview shows active quests. Update `progress:` in any quest where milestones completed.

**Section 6 — Reflection prompts:** Answer 2-3 honestly. No editing.

**Section 7 — Next week intention:** One sentence + 3 specific priorities + one quest milestone.

**Section 8 — Zettelkasten processing:**

- **8a:** Dataview surfaces the 5 oldest fleeting notes. Process each: promote / archive / delete.
- **8b:** Shows permanent notes written this week. If empty — write one before closing.
- **8c:** DataviewJS inbox health with status indicator that escalates target if backlog grows.

### Step 4 — Quest-Todoist sync (5 min)

Any completed or upcoming quest milestones → create corresponding Todoist task with due date.

- Health Reset → [Personal project](#)
- Work quest → [Work project](#)

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## Part 8: Monthly workflow — end of month (~30-45 min)

Dashboard → New monthly review. Read back through the month's weekly reviews first.

Fill `focus_minutes_total` and `rating` frontmatter from the metrics table. Note *direction of travel* per life area — trend matters more than the number. Run the **Monthly health check** section in `_docs/Vault State - June 2026.md`.

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## Part 9: Quarterly workflow — end of quarter (~2-3 hours)

The most important review in the system. Do not rush it.

**Step 1 — Todoist (30 min):** Archive completed tasks. Review backlogs. Mark LifeOS Learning sections complete if now living in the vault.

**Step 2 — Morgen Calendar (15 min):** Block dates for next quarter: Quarterly Review, Quarterly Planning, monthly reviews.

**Step 3 — Obsidian Quarterly Review (60-90 min):** Dashboard → New quarterly review. Read back through all weekly reviews, monthly reviews, every quest note, and Life Compass + Future Vision. 14 sections: quest retrospective, life area deep-dive, ten wins, values and identity check, vision check, learning summary. Run the quarterly audit queries in `_docs/Vault State - June 2026.md`.

**Step 4 — Quarterly Planning (30 min):** Design next quarter's quests (1-3 max). For each quest's key milestones, create a Todoist task with the quarter's end date as a soft deadline.

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## Part 10: Quests

Quests are 90-day focused efforts tied to one life area. Keep 1-3 active at a time.

**Creating a quest:** Dashboard → New quest. Rename immediately ( `F2` ) to `Topic-q3-2026` format — the filename drives the Weekly actions task query inside the note.

**Key frontmatter:** `area`, `quarter` (QX-YYYY), `due`, `progress` (0-100), `status` (Active / Completed / Abandoned)

### Progress health:

| Progress | Indicator |  
|---|---|  
| ≥ 66% | ☐ On track |  
| 33-65% | ☐ Check in |  
| < 33% | ☐ At risk |

Keep Completed and Abandoned quests — they're more valuable for quarterly retrospectives than you'd expect.

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## Part 11: Vision documents

**Life Compass** ( `01-Vision/life-compass.md` ) — Core values (3-5, personally defined), life roles with "showing up well" descriptions, and energy audit (1-5 per area). Fill this before creating any quests. Every quest should connect to it in one sentence. Review and update at each quarterly review.

**Future Vision** ( `01-Vision/future-vision.md` ) — 1-year, 3-year, 10-year vision written in past or present tense ("I have built..."), not "I want to...". Read before every quarterly planning session.

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## Part 12: Zettelkasten — the thinking layer

### The four note types

**Fleeting notes** (`06-Zettelkasten/Fleeting/`) — Quick captures. Process or delete within 48 hours. These are an inbox, not storage. **Current backlog: ~150 notes.**

**Target: process 10 per weekly review until below 50.**

**Literature notes** (`06-Zettelkasten/Literature/`) — One note per source, everything in your own words. 49 notes as of June 2026: 38 original + 11 IA/OT reference stubs (IEC 61511-1, NIST 800-82, Studio 5000 manual, etc.). Each book note in `05-Resources/Books/` links to its counterpart here via `literature_note:` frontmatter.

**Permanent notes** (`06-Zettelkasten/Permanent/`) — The core of the system. One atomic idea per note. Title must be a complete claim. 28 notes as of June 2026: 6 original cross-domain notes + 22 IA/OT domain stubs across instrumentation, PLC architecture, OT networking, and process safety. Stubs have empty body sections — fill one per week from the claim in the frontmatter.

Rules: self-contained, your words, linked ( $\geq 2$  outbound links), one idea. **Target: 1 new completed note per week.**

**Maps of Content** (`06-Zettelkasten/MOC/`) — Navigation notes created reactively when a cluster gets large. Current MOCs: Automation Engineering, HAM Radio, PKM & Zettelkasten, Personal Growth, Instrumentation, OT Networking, PLC Architecture, Process Safety (IEC 61511).

### Zettelkasten processing workflow

```
Capture → Fleeting note (Ctrl+Shift+F) or daily capture (Ctrl+Shift+C)
 ↓
Process → Permanent note (or literature note, or delete)
 ↓
Link → Add ≥ 2 outbound links before closing
 ↓
Navigate → Create MOC when cluster is too large to hold in head
```

The **Weekly Review Section 8** is the dedicated processing slot. The Dataview queue surfaces the 5 oldest fleeting notes automatically.



## Part 13: Work Knowledge base

`07-Work-Knowledge/` is the professional reference layer — 38 notes across 5 subfolders.

### Electrical fundamentals sequence (Automation subfolder)

1. ① DC Theory Overview
2. ② Basics of Electrical Current
3. ③ Electrical Resistance & Ohm's Law
4. ④ Electrical Power
5. ⑤ Sources and Loads

These fundamentals apply directly to **CAP exam Domains 1 & 3** and the **HAM General License G5 sub-element**. The HAM Radio MOC notes the crossover explicitly.

### CAP Certification prep

`07-Work-Knowledge/CAP-Certification/` has the domain breakdown and study timeline. Target: Q3 2027. Notes tagged `CAP-prep` are queryable via the quarterly audit in Vault State.

### HAM Radio study

`05-Resources/Courses/HAM-Radio/` — General License study system. Started June 8, 2026 with G1 Commission's Rules. Week-by-week syllabus with HamStudy.org integration.

## Part 14: Template reference

| Template         | Auto-applies to                    | Key frontmatter                                                                                                                     |
|------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Daily Note       | <code>04-Daily-Notes/</code>       | <code>date</code> , <code>type: daily</code> , <code>focus_minutes</code> , <code>vitals</code> fields                              |
| Weekly Review    | <code>03-Reviews/Weekly/</code>    | <code>date</code> , <code>week</code> , <code>type: weekly-review</code> , <code>rating</code> , <code>focus_minutes</code>         |
| Monthly Review   | <code>03-Reviews/Monthly/</code>   | <code>date</code> , <code>month</code> , <code>type: monthly-review</code> , <code>rating</code> , <code>focus_minutes_total</code> |
| Quarterly Review | <code>03-Reviews/Quarterly/</code> | <code>date</code> , <code>quarter</code> , <code>rating</code> , <code>quests_completed</code>                                      |

| Template            | Auto-applies to                 | Key frontmatter                                                      |
|---------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Quest               | 02-Quests/                      | area, quarter (QX-YYYY), status, due, progress (0-100)               |
| Book                | 05-Resources/<br>Books/         | author, status, date_started, date_finished, rating, literature_note |
| Article             | 05-Resources/<br>Articles/      | url, author, source, status                                          |
| Idea                | 05-Resources/<br>Ideas/         | area, status (raw/developing/parked/promoted)                        |
| Fleeting Note       | 06-Zettelkasten/<br>Fleeting/   | id (timestamp), date, type: fleeting                                 |
| Literature Note     | 06-Zettelkasten/<br>Literature/ | type: literature, source-type, source-author, book_note              |
| Automation Lit Note | 06-Zettelkasten/<br>Literature/ | type: literature, vendor, source_type, standard_ref                  |
| Permanent Note      | 06-Zettelkasten/<br>Permanent/  | type: permanent — rename immediately to claim title                  |
| Automation PN       | 06-Zettelkasten/<br>Permanent/  | type: permanent, maturity, domain: ia-ot, subdomain, moc             |
| MOC                 | 06-Zettelkasten/<br>MOC/        | type: moc                                                            |
| Attachment Note     | Manual                          | type: attachment, tags, source_doc                                   |

**Frontmatter quoting:** `focus_minutes:` and `steps:` must be bare integers, not quoted strings. `force-yaml-escape` is disabled in Linter to prevent this.

## Part 15: Vault maintenance routines

### Weekly (Sunday, during review — Section 8)

- [ ] Process 5-10 oldest fleeting notes (Dataview queue in Section 8a)
- [ ] Write  $\geq 1$  permanent note or fill  $\geq 1$  PN stub (Section 8b)
- [ ] Verify permanent notes created this week have  $\geq 2$  outbound links

- [ ] Update `progress:` in any quest where milestones completed
- [ ] Fill `rating:` and `focus_minutes:` in this week's review frontmatter

## Monthly (first Sunday of each month — Vault State note)

Open `_docs/Vault State - June 2026.md` and run the monthly health check:

- [ ] **Orphan detector** — notes with zero backlinks. Link, move to `_reference/`, or delete.
- [ ] **Fleeting inbox trend** — count with status indicator. Adjust weekly target if above 80.
- [ ] **Permanent notes created this month** — check link health ( $\geq 2$  outlinks,  $\geq 1$  inlink).
- [ ] **MOC freshness** — any MOC not updated in 30+ days? Review and update.
- [ ] Verify all weekly reviews have `rating:` and `focus_minutes:` filled.
- [ ] Archive fleeting notes tagged `processed` to `_archive/Fleeting/`.

## Quarterly (end of quarter — Vault State note)

Open `_docs/Vault State - June 2026.md` and run the quarterly audit:

- [ ] **Fleeting → permanent conversion rate** — target 1 permanent per 10 fleeting captured.
- [ ] **Archive processed fleeting notes** tagged `processed` → `_archive/Fleeting/`.
- [ ] **Work Knowledge coverage** — subfolder index link counts.
- [ ] **CAP domain coverage** — notes tagged `CAP-prep`.
- [ ] **HAM study progress** — HAM-Radio course notes by last-edited date.
- [ ] Update quest statuses (Active → Completed or Abandoned).
- [ ] Update Life Compass and Future Vision if direction has shifted.
- [ ] Graph view review — identify isolated permanent note clusters to link.

## Annual

- [ ] Archive completed quests, daily notes, and old reviews by year
- [ ] Open "All time" view in `vitals.base` — export for annual health checkup
- [ ] Review all MOCs for accuracy; prune stale links
- [ ] Prune reading list of books you've decided not to read

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## Part 16: Attachment system

`_attachments/` holds all binary files. The Attachment Catalog (`_attachments/Attachment Catalog.md`) tracks every file with a companion note.

### Adding a new attachment:

1. Drag the file into Obsidian — it saves to `_attachments/` automatically
2. Create a companion note using the Attachment Note Template
3. Add a row to `_attachments/Attachment Catalog.md`

## Part 17: Dataview and Bases troubleshooting

| Symptom                            | Likely cause                                                               | Fix                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Base shows empty table             | Notes don't match filter (wrong <code>status</code> or <code>type</code> ) | Check frontmatter spelling; run Linter                                                                      |
| Dataview shows nothing             | <code>type:</code> typo or notes in wrong folder                           | Check frontmatter; run <code>Dataview: Rebuild index</code>                                                 |
| Focus hours Section 3 blank        | <code>focus_minutes:</code> not filled in daily note frontmatter           | Copy session total from focus log into frontmatter                                                          |
| Focus bar shows 0%                 | Same as above — DataviewJS reads <code>focus_minutes</code> field          | Enter total minutes in Properties panel                                                                     |
| Vitals base shows nothing          | Linter quoted numbers ( <code>"2724"</code> not <code>2724</code> )        | Settings → Linter → YAML Rules → Force YAML Escape → <b>OFF</b>                                             |
| Vitals averages tables empty       | <code>bp_systolic &gt; 0</code> filter — no BP readings yet                | Add one BP reading, or filter on a field you do track                                                       |
| Permanent notes missing from index | Missing <code>type: permanent</code> or note in wrong folder               | Check Properties panel; confirm folder is <code>06-Zettelkasten/Permanent/</code>                           |
| Base shows raw YAML                | Bases core plugin disabled                                                 | Settings → Core plugins → Bases → ON                                                                        |
| Reviews not in dashboard bases     | Wrong <code>type:</code> value                                             | Must be <code>weekly-review</code> , <code>monthly-review</code> , or <code>quarterly-review</code> exactly |

## Part 18: Plugin troubleshooting

### Templates not firing on new note creation

Settings → Templater → confirm "Trigger Templater on new file creation" is ON. Verify

folder templates show all 12 assignments. Template file must be in `_templates/` exactly.

### Periodic notes not creating

| Type      | Format                          | Folder                            |
|-----------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Daily     | <code>YYYY-MM-DD</code>         | <code>04-Daily-Notes</code>       |
| Weekly    | <code>YYYY-[W]WW</code>         | <code>03-Reviews/Weekly</code>    |
| Monthly   | <code>YYYY-MM</code>            | <code>03-Reviews/Monthly</code>   |
| Quarterly | <code>YYYY-[Q]Q[-review]</code> | <code>03-Reviews/Quarterly</code> |

### QuickAdd hotkeys do nothing

Settings → QuickAdd → click the ⚡ lightning bolt icon next to each choice to toggle it as a command.

### Dashboard buttons do nothing

Settings → Community plugins → verify `obsidian-advanced-uri` is enabled. Vault name in URLs must match exactly (Settings → About).

### Commander buttons not showing

Three requirements must all be true: (1) `id` field must be the Obsidian command ID (e.g. `periodic-notes:open-daily-note`), not a UUID; (2) entry must have `"mode": "any"`; (3) for Tab Bar buttons, Settings → Appearance → Show tab title bar must be ON. See `_docs/Commander - Quick Reference.md` for full details and the correct JSON format.

### Linter breaking frontmatter numbers

Settings → Linter → General → Folders to Ignore → add `_templates`. Also ensure Force YAML Escape is **OFF**.

### Heatmap Calendar shows nothing

`focus_minutes:` must be a bare number > 0 in at least one daily note frontmatter.

---

## Part 19: Git backup

**Remote:** `https://github.com/glpelletier-jpg/slip-box-vault.git` · Branch: `master`

**Manual backup:** Run `_scripts/vault-backup.bat` (double-click in File Explorer or run from PowerShell). Commits with a timestamp and pushes to GitHub. Log saved to `c:\Vault\backup-log.txt`.

**Scheduled backup:** Windows Task Scheduler runs the script hourly. See `_docs/Vault Backup System.md` for full setup instructions, OneDrive sync configuration, and recovery procedures.

**Quick recovery:**

| Scenario | Tool |

|---|---|

| Deleted a note today | `Ctrl+P` → "File recovery: Open file recovery" |

| Deleted within 7 days | Obsidian File Recovery core plugin |

| Any historical version | GitHub → browse file history |

| Full vault restore | `git clone https://github.com/glpelletier-jpg/slip-box-vault.git`  
`"C:\Vault\Slip Box"` |

---

**Links:** Dashboard | Vault State | Commander | Getting Started

# Getting Started — First 30 Days

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## Getting Started — First 30 Days

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*The vault is built, audited, and fully wired. Every system is working. The only thing left is the habit.*

*This guide gives you a concrete checklist for the first 30 days — what to do, when, and why it matters.*

*Work through it top to bottom. Check things off as you go.*

---

### What's been set up for you

Before you start, here's what the vault contains and what's already working:

#### Structure:

- 8 numbered folders (00-Home through 07-Work-Knowledge) with folder notes and linked indexes
- `_templates/` — 18 templates, all wired to auto-fire via Templater when you create notes in the right folders
- `_scripts/` — weekly and next-week calendar fetchers, plus maintenance scripts
- `_attachments/` — Rockwell PDF manuals with companion notes and a catalog

#### Knowledge base:

- `07-Work-Knowledge/` — 38 notes including automation, networking, processes, troubleshooting, and CAP certification
- `06-Zettelkasten/Literature/` — 49 literature notes (38 originals + 11 IA/OT reference stubs)
- `06-Zettelkasten/Permanent/` — 28 permanent notes (6 originals + 22 IA/OT domain stubs across Instrumentation, PLC Architecture, OT Networking, Process Safety)
- `06-Zettelkasten/MOC/` — 8 Maps of Content: Automation Engineering, HAM Radio, PKM & Zettelkasten, Personal Growth, Instrumentation, OT Networking, PLC Architecture, Process Safety
- `05-Resources/Courses/HAM-Radio/` — complete General License study system: Master Reference, Syllabus, Study Resources

### Reviews:

- 4 weekly reviews (W20–W23) fully updated with auto-pulling focus minutes (Section 3) and Zettelkasten processing queue (Section 8)
- Weekly Review Template Section 3 pulls `focus_minutes` from your daily notes automatically — no manual tallying
- Weekly Review Template Section 8 shows the 5 oldest fleeting notes for processing, permanent notes written this week, and a live inbox health meter

### Maintenance:

- `_docs/Vault State - June 2026.md` — monthly orphan detector, fleeting inbox trend, permanent note health, and quarterly audit queries all built and ready

### Known remaining work (from you):

- Fill in the blank fields in `01-Vision/life-compass.md` — 4 values sections + 3 role sections
  - Update `progress:` in quest notes (both currently early stage)
  - Build the fleeting notes backlog down (~150 notes — target 10/week via weekly review)
  - Fill in the 22 IA/OT permanent note stubs — each has a Claim and empty body sections; write 1 per week
- 

## Week 1 — foundation habits

### Day 1: Tonight

- [ ] **Open today's daily note** (`Ctrl+D`). Write your `focus_intention:` for today in the Properties panel (⌘ icon). One sentence — what would make today a win?
  - [ ] **Write your first** `end_of_day:` — in the same Properties panel, find `end_of_day` and type one honest sentence about what actually happened. This is the first data point for the daily-focus tracker. Takes 30 seconds.
  - [ ] **Rate your energy** — enter a number 1–5 in the `energy:` field. End of day. Don't overthink it.
  - [ ] **Log today's vitals** — BP, pulse, glucose if you have it, steps from your phone or watch. This starts the vitals baseline.
-



## Before Sunday (Day 1-6): small setup tasks

- [ ] **Fill in the Life Compass energy audit** — open Life Compass, scroll to the energy audit table, and rate each of the 6 life areas 1-5. One number, one honest sentence each. Takes 5 minutes. This baseline makes every future review meaningful.

The six areas: Work & career · Health & energy · Relationships · Personal growth · Fun & creativity · Money & finances

- [ ] **Write your first permanent note** — `Ctrl+Shift+P`. Pick one thing you now believe based on building this vault or from recent reading. State it as a claim:
  - *"A system only compounds when the daily habit feeds it"*
  - *"Health is a multiplier, not a separate life category"*
  - *"Electrical resistance is friction —  $V=IR$  makes every circuit calculable"*

Write one paragraph. Link it to at least one other note (Life Compass, a quest, an existing permanent note). The Zettelkasten starts building density one note at a time.

- [ ] **Check your HAM Radio study schedule** — `05-Resources/Courses/HAM-Radio/General License Syllabus.md` has the full week-by-week study plan. Week 1 starts Jun 8: G1 Commission's Rules. Set up your HamStudy.org account before Monday.

---

## Sunday Week 1 — first weekly review

The vault earns its keep in the weekly review. Without it, data accumulates but never closes the loop.

- [ ] **Run** `Ctrl+Shift+W` to create the weekly review
- [ ] **Work through all 9 sections** with a 20-minute timer
- [ ] **Section 1b** — use `Ctrl+Shift+K` to pull this week's calendar into the note
- [ ] **Section 3** — Focus hours now auto-populate from your daily notes. Check the progress bar. Copy the total to `focus_minutes:` frontmatter.
- [ ] **Section 7** — use `Ctrl+Shift+J` to pull next week's calendar for the intention section
- [ ] **Section 8** — work through the 5 oldest fleeting notes in the Dataview queue. Decide each: promote to permanent / archive to literature / delete
- [ ] **Copy overall rating** (1-5) to `rating:` frontmatter
- [ ] **Update quest progress** — did the Health Reset habits get hit? Move `progress:` in the quest note if any movement happened

The first review will feel mechanical. By week 4 it will feel essential.

---

## Week 2 — building consistency

- [ ] **Daily notes every day** — just `Ctrl+D`, write `focus_intention:` in the morning and `end_of_day:` in the evening. 3 minutes maximum. The habit matters more than completeness right now.
- [ ] **Log focus sessions** — in the daily note's Focus Log section, log each work block in minutes:  
```\n
- [duration:: 90] HAM Radio study — G1 Commission's Rules
- [duration:: 60] Automation — reviewed a permanent note stub
`` The Total today: line sums automatically. Copy to `focus_minutes:` at end of day.
- [] **Add "Update quest progress" as a recurring Todoist task** — every Sunday, Personal project. The Health Reset dashboard health indicator stays red until you update `progress:` in the quest note.
- [] **Fill in a permanent note stub** — open any of the 22 IA/OT stubs in `06-Zettelkasten/Permanent/`. Each has a Claim already written. Write the Explanation, Evidence, Conditions, and Cross-links sections. One per week is the target.
- [] **Second weekly review (Sunday)** — same process. This time check Section 3 — do the focus hours feel accurate? Are all your daily `focus_minutes:` values filled in?

Week 3 — Zettelkasten activation

- [] **Third weekly review** — by now the Section 8 Dataview queue is your main mechanism for reducing the 150-note backlog. Process 10, write 1 permanent note.
- [] **Look at the daily-focus base** — open `00-Home/daily-focus.base` on "Last 7 days" view. Your `focus_intention:` and `end_of_day:` entries from the past two weeks are there. Is there a gap between what you intended each day and what happened? That gap is data. It becomes a permanent note.
- [] **Update Health Reset quest progress** — even partial milestone completion deserves moving `progress:` from 0. Each of the 4 top-level milestones = 25 points. Did you move consistently? Sleep target hit? Dietary drain avoided?
- [] **Install Obsidian Web Clipper** (browser extension) — the Articles folder and template are ready. The Web Clipper fills the Article template from any webpage in one click. Feeds `05-Resources/Articles/` without friction.

- [] **Check the Automation Engineering MOC** (`06-Zettelkasten/MOC/Automation Engineering MOC.md`) — review the full structure including Electrical Fundamentals and IA/OT linked stubs. If you've been reading automation material, add a reaction or question to the MOC's "Core tensions" section.
-

Week 4 — closing the first loop

- [] **Fourth weekly review**
 - [] **Compare Life Compass energy audit** — open `01-Vision/life-compass.md` and re-rate the 6 life areas. Compare to your Week 1 baseline. Has Health & energy moved since starting the Health Reset quest?
 - [] **Write a permanent note from the daily-focus data** — you have ~3 weeks of `focus_intention:` / `end_of_day:` pairs. Look at the base. What pattern do you see? There's a permanent note in there about how you actually work vs. how you intend to work.
 - [] **Review the HAM Radio MOC** (`06-Zettelkasten/MOC/HAM Radio MOC.md`) — it cross-references the Automation MOC on electrical fundamentals. If you've been studying both, add a note about what overlapped and what surprised you.
-

End of June — first monthly review

- [] **Run the monthly review** — Dashboard → New monthly review. 30–45 minutes.
- [] **Open Vault State** (`_docs/Vault State - June 2026.md`) and run the Monthly health check section:
 - Orphan detector — any notes with no backlinks?
 - Fleeting inbox trend — are you below 100 notes?
 - Permanent notes created this month — do they have links?
 - MOC freshness — any MOC not updated this month?
- [] **Look at the vitals base** — you'll have ~4 weeks of data. Average BP, glucose trend, steps per day, energy rating. First real data for your next diabetes appointment.
- [] **Check quest progress** — update `progress:` in both quest notes to reflect actual completion. The Health Reset milestone system: Month 1 = just show up (33%). Did you?

- [] **Re-rate Life Compass energy audit** — compare to Day 1 baseline. Three data points now: Day 1, Week 4, End of Month.

The non-negotiable daily routine

Three things, every day, under 5 minutes total. Everything else is optional.

| Time | Action | Where |
|---------|--|--|
| Morning | Write <code>focus_intention:</code> — one sentence | Properties panel in today's daily note |
| Evening | Write <code>end_of_day:</code> — one honest sentence | Properties panel in today's daily note |
| Evening | Rate <code>energy:</code> 1-5 and log steps | Properties panel in today's daily note |

The `focus_intention:` / `end_of_day:` pair is the most valuable data in the vault over time — more useful than the vitals, more useful than the focus log. It shows you the gap between who you intend to be on a given day and who you actually were.

The habit that matters most: Sunday review

Every tool in this vault — the quests, the vitals, the focus hours progress bar, the Zettelkasten queue — compounds through the weekly review. Without it, data accumulates but never closes the loop.

`Ctrl+Shift+W` is the command. The template is ready. Sections 3 and 8 now do most of the heavy lifting automatically. A full review takes 20 minutes with a timer.

The first 4 Sunday reviews will feel like work. After that they'll feel like something you don't want to skip.

Things to build in month 2+

Don't think about these now. Come back after your first monthly review.

- **HAM Radio electronics notes** — your Future Vision and HAM Radio MOC both point here. After the General License exam, the study notes convert into permanent Zettelkasten notes naturally.

- **CAP exam prep cluster** — [07-Work-Knowledge/CAP-Certification/](#) has the roadmap. The electrical fundamentals notes already cover Domains 1 and 3.
 - **Second quest for Q4** — Health Reset is the right single focus for Q3. If it's going well by September, the quarterly planning session is the right time to think about a second 90-day arc.
 - **Grow the permanent note network** — 28 stubs exist; the target is 50 fully written permanent notes by Q3 end. That's where linking starts to feel like thinking rather than filing.
 - **Life Compass completion** — the blank values sections and role sections. These inform every future quest. Complete before Q4 planning.
-

Links: [Dashboard](#) | [Master Guide](#) | [Life Compass](#) | [Health Reset Quest](#)

Vault Backup System

Vault Backup System

Two-layer backup: Git + Windows Task Scheduler (version history) + OneDrive (continuous cloud sync).

No Obsidian plugins required — everything runs at the OS level.

Architecture

| Layer | Tool | What it does | Cost |
|----------------------------|---|--|-------------------------|
| 1 — Version history | Git + GitHub + Task Scheduler | Commits and pushes every hour; complete rollback history | Free |
| 2 — Continuous sync | OneDrive | Real-time cloud copy; accessible from any device | Free (5GB with Windows) |
| 3 — Local recovery | Obsidian File Recovery (built-in core plugin) | Restores individual notes within the last 7 days — no setup required | Free |

Layer 1 protects against: accidental deletion, bad edits, plugin corruption, ransomware

Layer 2 protects against: drive failure, stolen/lost laptop

Layer 3 protects against: just deleted or overwrote a note in the last week

Layer 1: Git + GitHub + Windows Task Scheduler

One-time setup (~30 min)

Step 1 — Install Git for Windows

Download from git-scm.com/download/win and install with all default settings.

Step 2 — Create a free private GitHub repository

1. Go to github.com → create a free account

2. Click **+** → **New repository**

3. Name: `slip-box-vault` · Visibility: **Private** · No README

4. Click **Create repository**

5. Copy the URL shown (e.g., `https://github.com/glpelletier-jpg/slip-box-vault.git`)

Step 3 — Initialize Git in the vault

Open **Command Prompt** (`Win+R` → `cmd`) and run these commands one at a time:

```
cd "C:\Vault\Slip Box"
git init
git remote add origin https://github.com/glpelletier-jpg/slip-box-vault.git
git add .
git commit -m "Initial vault backup"
git push -u origin master
```

When prompted, enter your GitHub username and password (or a Personal Access Token — GitHub will guide you).

Step 4 — Create a `.gitignore` file

In the vault root, create `C:\Vault\Slip Box\.gitignore` with this content:

```
.obsidian/workspace
.obsidian/workspace.json
.obsidian/workspaces.json
.trash/
.DS_Store
```

This prevents Obsidian's window layout files (which change constantly) from cluttering the backup history.

Step 5 — The backup script is already in your vault

A backup script was created at `_scripts/vault-backup.bat`. To test it: open Command Prompt and run:

```
"C:\Vault\Slip Box\_scripts\vault-backup.bat"
```

It will pull, commit any changes, and push to GitHub. A log is saved to `C:\Vault\backup-log.txt`.

Step 6 — Schedule automatic hourly backups with Task Scheduler

1. Open **Task Scheduler** (search in Start menu)
2. Click **Create Basic Task** in the right panel
3. Name: `Obsidian Vault Backup` · Description: `Hourly Git backup of Slip Box vault`
4. Trigger: **Daily** (we'll refine this) → Next → set time to now
5. Action: **Start a program** → Next
6. Program/script: `"C:\Vault\Slip Box\_scripts\vault-backup.bat"`
7. Click Finish
8. Find the task in the list → right-click → **Properties**
9. Triggers tab → Edit → change to **Repeat task every: 1 hour** for a duration of **Indefinitely**
10. Click OK

The vault now backs up automatically every hour while the computer is on.

Layer 2: OneDrive (continuous cloud sync)

OneDrive is already installed on Windows 10/11 and provides real-time cloud sync.

Option A — Move the vault into OneDrive (recommended)

1. Sign in to OneDrive (click the cloud icon in the taskbar)
2. In File Explorer, move `C:\Vault\` to `C:\Users\[your name]\OneDrive\Vault\`
3. Update any desktop shortcuts or bookmarks to point to the new path
4. OneDrive syncs automatically from this point — you'll see a green checkmark on synced files

Option B — Add C:\Vault as a OneDrive backup folder

1. Right-click the OneDrive icon in the taskbar → Settings → Backup tab
2. Click **Manage backup** → add `C:\Vault`

⚠ Do NOT use multiple sync services (OneDrive + Dropbox + Google Drive) on the same folder simultaneously — sync conflicts can corrupt the vault. Pick one.

Layer 3: Obsidian File Recovery (already enabled)

Obsidian has a built-in **File Recovery** core plugin that saves snapshots of every note every few minutes. No setup needed — it's active by default.

To recover a note deleted or edited within the last 7 days:

1. `Ctrl+P` → "File recovery: Open file recovery"
2. Find the note and the version you want
3. Click **Restore**

This is the fastest recovery tool for day-to-day accidents (deleted a paragraph, overwrote the wrong note, etc.).

Obsidian Sync (optional — adds mobile access)

If you want to read and edit the vault on a phone or iPad:

- **Cost:** \$8/month or \$96/year
- **What it adds:** Encrypted sync across all devices, 1 year of version history, seamless mobile experience
- **What it doesn't replace:** Git backup — Obsidian Sync is not version control
- **Setup:** Obsidian → Settings → Sync

For free mobile access: the Obsidian mobile app can open a vault stored in OneDrive, though it requires manual sync and is less seamless.

Recovery scenarios

| What happened | How to recover |
|--|--|
| Deleted or overwrote a note (today) | <code>Ctrl+P</code> → "File recovery: Open file recovery" |
| Deleted a note (within 7 days) | File Recovery core plugin (above) |
| Deleted or corrupted a note (any time) | GitHub → find the file in history → view/download old version |
| Entire vault corrupted or deleted | <code>git clone https://github.com/glpelletier-jpg/slip-box-vault.git "C:\Vault\Slip Box"</code> |
| New laptop / reinstall | Install Git + Obsidian → clone repo → open vault in Obsidian |
| OneDrive sync issue | Git is the backup — the truth is always in GitHub |

Checking the backup is working

Verify Git is running:

1. Open `C:\Vault\backup-log.txt` — you should see recent timestamps
2. Or go to `github.com/glpelletier-jpg/slip-box-vault` — you should see recent commits

Verify OneDrive is synced:

- OneDrive icon in taskbar should show a green checkmark (not a spinning icon)

Monthly check: Open GitHub and confirm the latest commit is from within the last 24 hours.

The backup script (`_scripts/vault-backup.bat`)

The script in your vault does the following:

1. Navigates to `C:\Vault\Slip Box`
2. Pulls any remote changes (in case you edited from another device)
3. Stages all modified notes
4. If there are changes, commits with a timestamp and pushes to GitHub
5. Logs the result to `C:\Vault\backup-log.txt`

You can run it manually any time by double-clicking it in File Explorer.

Links: [Dashboard](#) | [Master Guide](#)

Commander Quick Reference

Commander — Quick Reference

Commander adds custom action buttons to Obsidian. This vault uses three Commander surfaces — all pointing to the same 5 core actions.

Configured buttons

| Button | Action | Command ID |
|-------------------------|--|--|
| Dashboard | Opens <code>00-Home/00-Home.md</code> | <code>homepage:open-homepage</code> |
| Today's Note | Opens or creates today's daily note | <code>periodic-notes:open-daily-note</code> |
| Weekly Review | Opens this week's review | <code>periodic-notes:open-weekly-note</code> |
| New Permanent Note | QuickAdd → Permanent Note template | <code>quickadd:choice:13aab76c-...</code> |
| New Troubleshooting Log | QuickAdd → Troubleshooting Log template | <code>quickadd:choice:6a34ec86-...</code> |
| Daily Capture | QuickAdd → appends to today's note capture inbox | <code>quickadd:choice:73fd090a-...</code> |

Where buttons appear

| Surface | Setting | Buttons |
|---|--|----------------------|
| Toolbar (top of every note) | Always on — no setting needed | All 5 action buttons |
| Left Ribbon (vertical sidebar strip) | Settings → Appearance → Show ribbon = ON | Dashboard (⌵) only |

| Surface | Setting | Buttons |
|----------------------------------|---|----------------------|
| Tab Bar (above open tabs) | Settings → Appearance → Show tab title bar = ON | All 5 action buttons |

The Toolbar is the most reliable surface — it appears in every open note with no extra settings required. If you don't use the Tab Bar or Ribbon, the Toolbar alone covers everything.

How to edit buttons

1. Settings → Commander
2. Select the surface tab (Ribbon / Tab Bar / Toolbar)
3. Click a button to rename it or change the icon
4. Click `+ Add command` to add a new button — search by command name
5. Drag to reorder

Troubleshooting

Button shows in Commander settings but doesn't appear in the vault

Three requirements must all be true for a button to render:

1. The `id` field in `.obsidian/plugins/cmdr/data.json` must be the Obsidian command ID (e.g. `periodic-notes:open-daily-note`), not a random UUID
2. The entry must include `"mode": "any"` (or `"desktop"` / `"mobile"`)
3. For Tab Bar: Settings → Appearance → Show tab title bar must be ON

If you edit `data.json` directly, Obsidian must be fully closed and reopened for changes to take effect.

Button appears but click does nothing

The command the button refers to isn't registered. This happens when:

- The plugin providing that command is disabled (e.g. QuickAdd disabled → QuickAdd buttons break)
- The QuickAdd choice was deleted or renamed (the UUID in the button ID becomes invalid)

Fix: Settings → Commander → remove the broken button → Add command → search again.

"No commands here!" in Commander settings

This is the display when the entries in `data.json` have invalid command IDs.

Open `.obsidian/plugins/cmdr/data.json`, check that `id` fields are actual command IDs (not UUIDs), and that each entry has `"mode": "any"`.

Configuration file location

`.obsidian/plugins/cmdr/data.json`

The three relevant keys and their valid entry format:

```
{
  "leftRibbon": [
    {
      "id": "homepage:open-homepage",
      "name": "Dashboard",
      "icon": "home",
      "mode": "any",
      "color": ""
    }
  ],
  "titleBar": [
    {
      "id": "periodic-notes:open-daily-note",
      "name": "Today's Note",
      "icon": "calendar-days",
      "mode": "any",
      "color": ""
    }
  ],
  "pageHeader": [
    {
      "id": "periodic-notes:open-daily-note",
      "icon": "lucide-calendar-days",
      "name": "Today's Note",
      "mode": "any"
    }
  ]
}
```

```
]
}
```

Note: `pageHeader` (Toolbar) uses slightly different key names — `icon` uses `lucide-` prefix format and

Life Compass — Complete Procedure

Life Compass — Complete Procedure

A step-by-step guide to filling in, maintaining, and using the Life Compass. Every quest, every weekly review, and every values check connects back to this document. If the Life Compass is weak, everything downstream is weaker.

Location: 01-Vision/life-compass.md

Review frequency: Every quarterly review (every 90 days) · Update immediately when something genuinely changes

What the Life Compass is

The Life Compass is your personal operating system's foundation layer. It answers three questions:

1. **What do I actually value?** — Not what you think you should value. What genuinely matters to you when you're honest.
2. **Who am I trying to be in each role?** — Parent, professional, builder. What does showing up well actually look like?
3. **How is my life going right now?** — The energy audit gives each area a number so you can track direction over time.

Everything else in the vault uses this:

- Quests must connect to a value or role in the Life Compass
- Weekly reviews rate each life area using the same 6 categories
- Monthly and quarterly reviews check whether you lived your values
- The Future Vision describes where these values take you

If the Life Compass is blank or generic, the reviews become meaningless exercises. If it's specific and honest, every review becomes a genuine reckoning.

Part 1: Core values

What they are

Your core values are the 3-5 things that, when you violate them, make you feel like you've betrayed yourself. Not aspirations — not things you wish were true. Things that already feel like *you* when you're at your best.

The vault has five pre-filled values based on your Future Vision: Presence, Integrity, Creation, Foundation, Deliberateness. These are correct starting points — edit them to fit if needed, add or remove as your understanding evolves.

Step 1: Write your personal definition

Field: "What it means to me"

This is not a dictionary definition. This is what the value means *in your life, in your context, in concrete situations*.

How to do it:

1. Open `01-Vision/life-compass.md` (press `Ctrl+H` or click Life Compass on the dashboard)
2. For each value, click inside the `>` blockquote after "What it means to me:"
3. Write 2-4 sentences in plain language. Be specific about the contexts where this value matters to you.

Example of what NOT to write: "Integrity means being honest."

Example of what to write: "Integrity means doing what I said I'd do. Being honest and straight with people — not managing impressions, not softening things to the point of misleading. The career I want is built on doing great work and being someone people trust."

The test: Could a stranger reading your definition understand exactly what you mean? Could they recognize a violation of it when they saw one?

Step 2: Describe what violating it looks like

Field: "What violating it looks like"

This is the most important field in the values section. Violations are concrete and observable — they ground the value in reality.

How to do it:

1. Think of a time you felt bad about yourself. What value did that behavior violate?
2. Describe the specific behavior, not the feeling. "Saying yes when I mean maybe" is better than "not being honest enough."
3. Keep it to 2-3 sentences — specific, behavioral, observable.

Why this matters: When you do the weekly review and ask "did I live this value?", you need concrete behaviors to check against. Abstract violations ("I wasn't very present") don't change anything. Specific ones ("I was on my phone while my kids were talking to me") do.

Step 3: Write how you want to show up

Field: "How I want to show up"

This is your aspiration — the best version of yourself expressing this value. Write it in the present tense as if it's already true.

How to do it:

1. Ask: if I were living this value fully, what would someone observing me notice?
2. Write 1-2 sentences. Keep it concrete enough to recognize.

Example: "Curious and strong-minded" (Presence). "Comfortable that I do not have to remember any lies — people can depend on what I tell them" (Integrity).

Important: Don't write a generic aspiration. "I want to be more present" is useless. "When I'm with my kids, the phone goes in another room and I give them my full attention" is actionable.

Part 2: Life roles**What they are**

Roles are the hats you wear. Where values are internal (what you believe), roles are relational (how you show up for others). The three pre-defined roles are Parent, Professional, and Builder/Creator — add others as needed (partner, friend, community member, etc.).

Step 4: Define "showing up well"

Field: "Showing up well looks like:"

This defines success in each role. It should be specific enough that at the end of any week, you know whether you did it or not.

How to do it:

1. Ask: if I were doing this role as well as I possibly could, what would that look like in practice?
2. Think of one person you know who shows up well in this role. What do they actually *do*?
3. Write 2–4 sentences. Behaviors, not feelings.

Example: "Present and engaged, not just in the same room. Full attention when we're together — the mental noise quieted enough to give them what they need."

Step 5: Honestly identify where you're falling short

Field: "Where I'm falling short right now:"

This is the hardest section. It requires actual honesty, not polished self-awareness. Write the real thing, not the version that makes you look thoughtful.

How to do it:

1. Think about the last two weeks. In this role, what did you not do that you said you would?
2. What feedback have you received (directly or indirectly) that you're not meeting the standard?
3. Write 1–3 sentences. Plain language. No hedging.

Example of hedging (don't write this): "I could be more intentional about quality time."

Example of honest (write this): "Too busy with my own growth — spending more time on the vault than with the kids."

This section hurts to write. Write it anyway. The weekly review will reference it.

Step 6: Commit to one change

Field: "One thing I want to do differently:"

One specific, behavioral change. Not a resolution — a commitment to a specific action.

How to do it:

1. Look at what you wrote in "falling short"

2. Ask: what is the single most concrete change that would address this?
3. Write one sentence. If it takes more than one sentence, it's too vague or too big.

Example: "Spend more time with the kids" — works. "Be more present in general" — doesn't work (too vague). "Put phone in another room every evening after dinner and spend 30 minutes with the kids doing whatever they want" — best (specific and testable).

Part 3: Energy audit

What it is

The energy audit rates your life across 6 areas on a 1–5 scale. The ratings aren't meant to be permanent — they're meant to reflect *right now* so you can see direction of travel at each review.

The six areas are:

- **Work & career** — quality of work, energy, progress, feeling of direction
 - **Health & energy** — sleep, exercise, food, physical energy levels
 - **Relationships** — connection, investment, quality of interactions with the people you care about
 - **Personal growth** — learning, progress toward becoming who you want to be
 - **Fun & creativity** — joy, play, creative expression, things you do just because you want to
 - **Money & finances** — security, progress, absence of money stress
-

Step 7: Rate each area honestly

How to do it:

1. Open the Energy Audit table in Life Compass
2. For each area, ask: "On a scale of 1–5, how is this area actually going *right now*?" Not how it should be. Not how it could be. How it IS.
3. Scoring guide:
 - **1** — This area is in crisis or completely neglected
 - **2** — Significantly below where I want it to be, problems are real
 - **3** — Functional but not thriving — acceptable, not good
 - **4** — Going well, mostly satisfied, minor gaps
 - **5** — Genuinely excellent, couldn't want much more right now

4. Fill in the "One honest sentence" column with a factual observation, not a judgment. "Just started a new job with Argenta" is better than "Struggling professionally."

Common mistake: Inflating ratings to feel better. The audit is only useful if it's honest. A 2 that you acknowledge is more useful than a 4 that avoids the real situation.

Step 8: Update the last_reviewed date

After completing or reviewing the Life Compass:

1. Open the Properties panel ( icon at the top of the note)
2. Find `last_reviewed`
3. Enter today's date in `YYYY-MM-DD` format

This timestamp appears in quarterly reviews and tells you when the last honest look happened.

Part 4: Quarterly review process

The Life Compass should be reviewed and potentially updated at every quarterly review (approximately every 90 days). Here's how:

Step 9: Read it before reviewing

Before the quarterly review session, read the entire Life Compass from top to bottom. Don't edit while reading — just take it in. Ask yourself:

- Does this still feel true?
 - Has anything shifted in how I think about these values?
 - Have any of the roles changed?
-

Step 10: Check the values section

For each value:

- Read your "What it means to me" — is it still accurate? Did you learn something this quarter that changes it?
- Read "What violating it looks like" — did you actually experience any of these violations? Was the description accurate?
- Read "How I want to show up" — are you closer to this than you were 90 days ago?

Edit if: Something genuinely shifted in your understanding. Not because you failed to live it, but because you see it differently.

Don't edit if: You just fell short of it. Falling short means keep working at it, not redefine it.

Step 11: Update the roles section

The roles section changes more often than the values section as life circumstances shift.

For each role:

1. Update "Where I'm falling short right now" — what's true NOW, not what was true 90 days ago
 2. Update "One thing I want to do differently" — should be a fresh commitment, not the same one from last quarter (if it's the same one, ask why it didn't happen)
 3. Optionally: add a new role if your life has added a significant relationship or commitment
-

Step 12: Re-do the energy audit

1. Rate all 6 areas fresh without looking at last quarter's numbers
2. After rating, compare to last quarter
3. Note the direction of travel (↑ ↑ → ↓) for each area
4. The areas that dropped are the candidates for next quarter's quest

The key question: "Which area, if I invested in it this quarter, would raise my overall satisfaction the most?" That area usually becomes a quest.

Step 13: Update last_reviewed

Change `last_reviewed` in the Properties panel to today's date.

Part 5: How the Life Compass connects to everything else

Quests

Every quest must connect to the Life Compass. The quest template asks: "One sentence connecting to your Life Compass or Future Vision." If you can't write that sentence, the quest is being driven by obligation or external pressure, not your actual values.

Current quests:

- **Health Reset** → Foundation value + Health & energy audit area

- **New Role Integration** → Integrity + Deliberateness values + Work & career audit area

Weekly reviews

Section 6 of the weekly review asks: "Did you act in line with your core values?" You open the Life Compass (or remember it), and answer honestly. The "violating it looks like" descriptions are what you check against.

Section 2 rates the same 6 life areas you rated in the energy audit, but weekly. Over time you can see whether your interventions (quests, habits) are actually moving the numbers.

Monthly reviews

Section 7 does a formal values check — for each value, "How I lived it" and "Where I fell short." The Life Compass is the answer key.

Quarterly reviews

The quarterly review includes a full Life Compass update (Steps 9-13 above) and a decision about whether the values and roles still reflect who you are.

Common mistakes

Mistake 1: Writing aspirations instead of truths

The Life Compass should describe who you ARE and what you VALUE — not who you want to be. Values in the future tense are goals, not values. Keep it present tense and honest.

Mistake 2: Keeping it at a high level

"I value honesty" is not useful. "I value doing what I said I'd do, even when it's uncomfortable, and I feel genuinely bad when I manage someone's impression of me instead of being straight" is useful. The specificity is the point.

Mistake 3: Not revisiting it

A Life Compass filled in once and never touched again becomes a historical artifact rather than a living document. The quarterly review is the minimum cadence for a check-in.

Mistake 4: Treating it as performance

This document is private and functional. Write what's true, not what sounds good. The

"falling short" sections are the most valuable fields in the document — they only work if they're honest.

Mistake 5: Making quests without consulting it

If a quest doesn't connect to the Life Compass, it's responding to external pressure.

Use the compass to sanity-check every new commitment.

Links: [Life Compass](#) | [Future Vision](#) | [Quests](#) | [Master Guide](#)

Zettelkasten — Complete Procedure

Zettelkasten — Complete Procedure

A step-by-step guide to every aspect of the Zettelkasten system — how to capture, process, write, link, and navigate. The Zettelkasten is the thinking layer of the vault. Everything else in the system is infrastructure. This is where knowledge actually compounds.

Location: 06-Zettelkasten/

Current state: ~150 fleeting · 49 literature · 28 permanent · 8 MOCs

What the Zettelkasten is — and why it works differently

Most note-taking systems are filing cabinets. You store things in them so you don't lose them. The Zettelkasten is not a filing cabinet — it's a thinking partner.

The difference: in a filing cabinet, notes are passive. In a Zettelkasten, notes are connected to each other through deliberate links. When you connect Idea A to Idea B, you often discover Idea C that you didn't know you had. That's not retrieval — it's generation. You're producing new thinking, not just storing old thinking.

This only happens if you follow the rules. The rules are not bureaucratic — every rule exists because skipping it eliminates the benefit.

The four rules:

1. One idea per note
 2. Every permanent note title is a complete claim, not a topic
 3. Every permanent note links to at least 2 other permanent notes
 4. Notes are written in your own words — no copy-paste
-

The four note types

| Type | Folder | Purpose | Lifespan |
|----------|--------|---------|------------------|
| Fleeting | | | 48 hours maximum |

| Type | Folder | Purpose | Lifespan |
|------------|---------------------------------|---|-----------------------------|
| | 06-Zettelkasten/
Fleeting/ | Quick capture — don't lose the idea | |
| Literature | 06-Zettelkasten/
Literature/ | What a source says, in your words | Permanent reference |
| Permanent | 06-Zettelkasten/
Permanent/ | One atomic idea you actually believe | Permanent, grows with links |
| MOC | 06-Zettelkasten/
MOC/ | Navigation map for a cluster of permanent notes | Created when needed |

Part 1: Fleeting notes

What they are

A fleeting note is a quick capture. Its only job is to preserve an idea long enough for you to process it. It is NOT a note you will keep — it is a staging area.

Think of it like a sticky note you write on your hand: valuable for the next few hours, worthless after that.

Step 1: Create a fleeting note

When to use it: Any time a thought occurs that you don't want to lose but can't process right now. A book passage, a shower thought, a connection you noticed, a question that came up at work.

How to create it:

Option A — Hotkey (fastest):

Press `Ctrl+Shift+F` from anywhere in Obsidian. A new note is created in `06-Zettelkasten/Fleeting/` with the current timestamp as the filename. Start typing immediately.

Option B — Daily note capture (for small captures):

Press `Ctrl+Shift+C`. Type the thought. It appends to the Capture inbox in today's daily note without opening it. Use this for single sentences or fragments.

Option C — In the Zettelkasten index:

Open `06-Zettelkasten/06-Zettelkasten.md` → click "New fleeting note" in the Quick actions table.

Step 2: Write the fleeting note

The bar for a fleeting note is extremely low. Just get the idea down. You don't need complete sentences. You don't need context. You need enough to reconstruct the idea when you come back to it.

What to write:

- The idea itself (even just a phrase)
- Where it came from (source, book, conversation, your own thinking)
- Which processing destination makes sense (permanent note? literature note? idea? delete?)

Example of a good fleeting note:

```
Struggling with the Powerflex 753 fault – the drive keeps faulting on overcurrent during ramp-up. Checked wiring, looks clean. Maybe accel time too aggressive?  
→ Process to: Troubleshooting log
```

Example of a bad fleeting note:

```
interesting idea
```

That second one is unprocessable. Future you has no idea what it means.

Step 3: Process the fleeting note within 48 hours

This is the most important rule in the entire system. Fleeting notes that aren't processed within 48 hours become permanent clutter. You will look at them weeks later and have no idea what they meant.

Processing means making one of five decisions:

1. **Write a permanent note** — The idea is worth keeping as an atomic claim. Go to Part 3.
2. **Add to a literature note** — The idea came from a specific source. Find or create that literature note and add it there.

3. **Create a troubleshooting log** — The idea is a work incident. Use `Ctrl+Shift+T` to create a log.
4. **Move to Ideas** — The idea is project-shaped ("build a GPS tracker"). Move it to `05-Resources/Ideas/`.
5. **Delete** — The idea was a passing thought that doesn't have real value. Delete without guilt.

When to process: Sunday weekly review, Section 8 (Zettelkasten inbox). This is the built-in processing cadence. Every Sunday, open `06-Zettelkasten/Fleeting/`, work through what's there, and make a decision on each note.

The fleeting inbox queue in `06-Zettelkasten.md` shows all unprocessed fleeting notes sorted by date. The oldest ones at the top are your priority.

Part 2: Literature notes

What they are

A literature note captures what a specific source (book, article, video, podcast) says — in your own words. One literature note per source.

The critical rule: **no copy-paste**. Copying highlights into a note feels like learning. It isn't. When you restate an idea in your own words, your brain has to actually process it. That processing is what creates understanding.

Step 4: Create a literature note

When to use it: When you've read, watched, or listened to something and want to capture what it said in a way that's useful for future thinking.

How to create it:

1. Open `06-Zettelkasten/06-Zettelkasten.md` → click "New literature note"
2. OR navigate to `06-Zettelkasten/Literature/` and create a new note there (Templater applies the template automatically)

How to name it: The book or source title. Keep it simple and findable.

Step 5: Fill in the literature note

The literature note has six sections:

Section 1: The source in one sentence

Before doing anything else, write one sentence that captures what the entire source is about. This forces you to understand the big picture before getting into details. If you can't write this sentence, you don't understand the source well enough to take notes from it.

Section 2: Key ideas in your own words

This is the most valuable section. Write 3 key ideas from the source — but not as the author said them. As *you* would explain them to someone who hasn't read it. No quotes allowed here.

Test: could you explain each idea to someone in a conversation? If yes, write it as you'd say it out loud. If no, you don't understand it yet — go back and read the relevant section again.

Section 3: Quotes worth keeping

Paste quotes *sparingly* — only 2-3 lines you would actually re-read. Not every highlight. Not every good sentence. The ones you'd want to show someone.

Section 4: My reaction

Do you agree with this? Does it change anything you believed? What questions does it raise? This section is where you start thinking for yourself about the source, not just summarizing it.

Section 5: Permanent notes spawned

After writing the key ideas section, you'll have ideas that belong as permanent notes. List them here as you create them — `permanent-note-filename`. This is the connection between the literature layer and the permanent note layer.

Section 6: Connections

Other notes, quests, or ideas this source connects to. Does the source connect to your Health Reset quest? Your automation work? A question you've been thinking about? Write those links here.

Step 6: Link the literature note to its source book

If the source is a book you're tracking in `05-Resources/Books/`, open that book's note and link to the literature note in the "Linked notes" section:

```
**Literature note:** Atomic Habits
```

This keeps the reading list and the knowledge layer connected.

Part 3: Permanent notes

What they are

Permanent notes are the core of the Zettelkasten. Everything else exists to serve them. A permanent note is one atomic idea that you actually believe, written in a way that stands completely on its own.

The permanent note layer is where knowledge compounds. When you have 50 permanent notes linked together, reading one note surfaces connections to 10 others. Ideas from different domains start connecting in ways you didn't plan. This is the "conversation with yourself across time" that Luhmann described.

Step 7: Recognize when to write a permanent note

Write a permanent note when:

- You've had an insight you want to preserve and build on
- A key idea from a literature note deserves to stand on its own
- You notice a connection between two existing ideas
- You've formed an opinion on something after reading or thinking about it
- The idea will still matter to you in 5 years

Do NOT write a permanent note for:

- Facts you can look up
 - Information that's only relevant to a specific project (that goes in the project or work knowledge folder)
 - Summaries of someone else's thinking (that's a literature note)
 - Ideas you're not sure you believe yet (that's a fleeting note)
-

Step 8: Title the permanent note with a claim

This is the most important skill in the entire Zettelkasten. The title must be a **complete claim** — a sentence that asserts something true. Not a topic.

The test: Can you agree or disagree with the title?

- "Habits" — NO (topic, can't agree or disagree)
- "Habits require identity change not just behavior change" — YES (claim, can agree or disagree)

More examples:

| ❑ Topic (don't use) | ❑ Claim (use this) |
|---------------------|--|
| Flow states | Flow requires challenge calibrated just above current skill |
| PLC arrays | PLC arrays reduce ladder logic complexity by an order of magnitude |
| Sleep | Sleep deprivation degrades decision quality faster than it degrades physical performance |
| Attention | A single interruption costs 23 minutes of focus recovery |

Why this matters: The title forces you to have a position. A permanent note titled "Flow" could contain anything. A note titled "Flow requires challenge calibrated just above current skill" is specific enough to link to other specific claims — "Boredom signals that challenge is too low" or "Anxiety signals that challenge exceeds current skill." The connections between specific claims generate insight. The connections between topics generate filing.

File naming convention: Use the "PN — [Full claim title]" format already in use:

```
PN — Flow requires challenge calibrated just above current skill.md
```

Step 9: Create the permanent note

Method 1 — Hotkey:

Press `Ctrl+Shift+P`. A new note is created in `06-Zettelkasten/Permanent/`. The first thing you do is press `F2` and rename it to "PN — [claim]". Do this immediately — before you write anything.

Method 2 — Command palette:

```
Ctrl+P → "QuickAdd: New Permanent Note" → enter the claim as the filename.
```

The Permanent Note Template is applied automatically. You'll see four sections to fill in.

Step 10: Fill in the permanent note

The permanent note has four sections:

Section 1: The idea

State the claim from the title in 2–5 sentences. No hedging. No "this might be" or "I

think perhaps." Commit to a position. Write as if explaining to your future self who will read this without context.

Bad: "Habits might be related to identity in some way."

Good: "Behavioral change that doesn't shift identity eventually reverts. The new behavior keeps triggering the old self-concept: 'I'm not someone who exercises regularly.' Identity change means starting with 'I am someone who moves every day' and collecting evidence for it. Once the identity is secure, the behavior maintains itself."

Section 2: Why it matters

So what? What changes if this is true? This forces you to understand the implications of the idea, not just the idea itself.

Example: "If identity drives behavior more than willpower, then trying harder at habits is the wrong intervention. The right intervention is acting as if the identity is already true and accumulating small pieces of evidence for it."

Section 3: Evidence / examples

A concrete example from your own life, from a book, or from something you observed. At least one. The example grounds the abstract claim in something real.

Section 4: Counterarguments / limits

Where does this idea break down or not apply? Every good claim has limits.

Acknowledging them makes the note more accurate and also forces you to think more carefully about what you actually believe.

Step 11: Add at least 2 outbound links

This step is non-negotiable. A permanent note with no links is an orphan — it can't contribute to unexpected connections, which is the entire point of the system.

How to link:

In the "Links" section of the template:

- PN — name-of-other-permanent-note — *because (state the relationship)*
- PN — another-permanent-note — *contrasts with / extends / supports*

The relationship text matters. "Because," "contrasts with," "extends," "supports," "depends on" — these specify how the ideas relate. Generic links ("see also") are less valuable than directional links ("this is why the previous note is true").

Types of relationships:

- **Supports:** "This evidence supports the claim in that note"
- **Contrasts with:** "This is the opposing view or limit case"
- **Extends:** "This takes the idea further in one direction"
- **Depends on:** "This note only makes sense if that note is true"
- **Applied in:** "This abstract claim is applied in that specific context"

When you don't have 2 permanent notes yet: Link to the most relevant literature note or MOC as a placeholder. Then come back when you have more permanent notes and upgrade the links.

Step 12: Record the origin

In the "Origin" section, write where this note came from:

- A literature note: `Atomic Habits`
- A fleeting note: "Fleeting note from [date], thinking about the Health Reset"
- Your own thinking: "Emerged while writing the New Role Integration quest"

This traceability makes the note more trustworthy (you know it's not just a half-remembered idea) and lets you go back to the source if you want more context.

Part 4: Maps of Content (MOCs)

What they are

A Map of Content is a navigation note created when a cluster of permanent notes gets too large to hold in your head. It groups permanent notes by sub-theme, identifies the core tensions, and provides entry points.

A MOC is NOT:

- An outline for writing
- A folder structure
- A summary of the notes it links to
- Something you create upfront before having notes

A MOC IS:

- A navigation aid you create reactively, when you notice a cluster emerging
- A place that makes explicit what the connections between notes mean
- A note that names the open questions and tensions in a cluster

Rule: Create a MOC when you need one, not before. If you can hold all the notes in a theme in your head, you don't need a MOC yet.

Step 13: Create a MOC

When: When a cluster of permanent notes around a theme gets too large to navigate mentally. Usually 8-10 related permanent notes is the signal.

How:

1. `Ctrl+P` → "QuickAdd: New MOC" OR create a note in `06-Zettelkasten/MOC/`
2. Name it: "MOC — Theme Name" (e.g., "MOC — Automation Engineering")
3. Use the MOC Template

Sections to fill in:

- **What this map covers** — one sentence describing the territory
- **Entry points** — the 2-3 permanent notes that are the best starting place for someone new to this theme
- **Core tensions/debates** — what are the big disagreements or open questions within this theme?
- **Note clusters** — group permanent notes by sub-theme with brief descriptions
- **Connected MOCs** — which other MOCs relate to this one?
- **Open questions** — what permanent notes still need to be written to fill gaps?

Current MOCs in this vault:

- Automation Engineering MOC
 - PKM and Zettelkasten MOC
 - Personal Growth MOC
 - HAM Radio MOC
 - MOC — Instrumentation
 - MOC — OT Networking
 - MOC — PLC Architecture
 - MOC — Process Safety
-

Part 5: The weekly processing workflow

What happens every Sunday

The Zettelkasten requires a weekly maintenance session. It's Section 8 of the weekly review: "Zettelkasten inbox." Budget 20-30 minutes.

Step 14: Process the fleeting inbox

1. Open `06-Zettelkasten/06-Zettelkasten.md`
2. Look at the "Fleeting inbox" Dataview table — these are all notes with `type: fleeting`
3. Work through them oldest-first
4. For each note, make one of the five decisions (permanent note / literature note / troubleshooting log / idea / delete)
5. When a note is processed, either delete it or change its `type:` to something other than `fleeting` (if keeping for reference)

Goal: Inbox to zero every Sunday. Notes that are more than a week old are past the processing window — they should be ruthlessly deleted unless the idea is genuinely worth the time to process properly.

Step 15: Write 2-3 permanent notes

This is the core habit. Every Sunday, write 2-3 permanent notes from whatever source material is richest — usually a literature note you've been reading or a recent insight.

How to choose which claims to write:

Use the Literature Processing Guide — it lists ready claims organized by Tier 1 (process now) through Tier 3 (process when ready). Pick the top item from the Tier 1 queue and write its highest-priority claim.

Time budget: 15-20 minutes per permanent note. Two notes = 30-40 minutes. This is the right trade-off — go slower and write notes that last, not faster and write notes that need to be rewritten.

Step 16: Check the review queue

The Zettelkasten index has a "Review queue" — permanent notes not touched in 30+ days. The slip box only compounds if you revisit and relink old notes.

How to use it:

1. Open `06-Zettelkasten/06-Zettelkasten.md`
2. Look at the "Review queue" section
3. Pick one note from the queue
4. Read it — does it still seem true? Does a new connection to a recent note suggest itself?
5. Add at least one new link if possible

This step takes 5 minutes and directly increases the connection density of the system over time.

Step 17: Check notes needing links

The "Notes needing links" section in the Zettelkasten index shows permanent notes with fewer than 2 outbound links. These are the weakest notes — they can't participate in unexpected connections.

For each note with fewer than 2 links:

1. Open the note
2. Read the claim
3. Think of other permanent notes it relates to — what does this note support, contrast with, or depend on?
4. Add at least one link with a relationship description

Even adding one link per note per week compounds significantly over time.

Part 6: The long-term view

How the Zettelkasten changes over time

At 10 permanent notes: The system feels like overhead. You're maintaining it more than getting value from it. This is normal. Keep going.

At 25 permanent notes: You start noticing that writing a new note naturally suggests links to 3–4 existing notes. The system is beginning to have surface area.

At 50 permanent notes: Reading a permanent note now surfaces unexpected connections. You discover something you believe but didn't know you'd articulated. The conversation with yourself is starting.

At 100+ permanent notes: The system becomes genuinely generative. You can't write a note in one cluster without it connecting to another cluster. Ideas compound non-linearly.

The vault currently has 28 permanent notes (6 original + 22 IA/OT stubs). The target is 50 by end of Q3. The Literature Processing Guide has the material — the work is just writing.

What makes a Zettelkasten fail

Failure mode 1: Collecting without processing

The vault has ~150 fleeting notes. Collecting is comfortable. Processing is uncomfortable. The Zettelkasten only works if processing happens.

Failure mode 2: Copy-pasting instead of restating

If you copy highlights into notes, you're building a better filing cabinet, not a thinking partner. The restatement step — writing the idea in your own words — is where the understanding happens. Skip it and the value disappears.

Failure mode 3: Topic titles instead of claim titles

A permanent note titled "Habits" can link to anything. A permanent note titled "Habits require identity change not just behavior change" can only link to things that specifically relate to that claim. The specificity is what makes connections meaningful.

Failure mode 4: Not linking

Orphaned notes can't participate in the system. Before closing any permanent note, the Links section must have at least 2 entries. This is the rule that most people skip and the one that matters most.

Failure mode 5: Treating MOCs as organization

MOCs are navigation aids you create reactively, not an upfront folder structure. Creating MOCs before you have the permanent notes they're supposed to organize is backwards.

Quick reference

| Action | Hotkey | Where it goes |
|-----------------------------------|---|--|
| New fleeting note | <code>Ctrl+Shift+F</code> | <code>06-Zettelkasten/Fleeting/</code> |
| Quick capture (no context switch) | <code>Ctrl+Shift+C</code> | Today's daily note capture inbox |
| New permanent note | <code>Ctrl+Shift+P</code> | <code>06-Zettelkasten/Permanent/</code> |
| New literature note | From Zettelkasten index → Quick actions | <code>06-Zettelkasten/Literature/</code> |
| New MOC | From Zettelkasten index → Quick actions | <code>06-Zettelkasten/MOC/</code> |

| Action | Hotkey | Where it goes |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------|--|
| Open Zettelkasten index | Click link from dashboard | 06-Zettelkasten/06-Zettelkasten.md |
| Literature Processing Guide | Click link from index | 06-Zettelkasten/Literature Processing Guide.md |

Links: Zettelkasten index | Literature Processing Guide | Master Guide | PKM MOC

Vault Systems — Complete Procedure

Vault Systems — Complete Procedure

Step-by-step procedures for everything in the vault not covered by the Life Compass and Zettelkasten guides. This document covers: daily notes, focus logging, vitals tracking, weekly reviews, monthly reviews, quarterly reviews, quest management, resource management, the three-tool system, attachments, and the backup system.

Companion documents:

- Life Compass — Complete Procedure
 - Zettelkasten — Complete Procedure
-

Part 1: The Daily Note

What it is

The daily note is the operational layer of the vault — the place where each day is planned, worked, and closed. It tracks your focus intention, quest habits, focus time, vitals, and end-of-day reflection. Over time these notes feed the dashboard charts, weekly reviews, and vitals tracker.

Location: `04-Daily-Notes/YYYY-MM-DD.md`

Hotkey: `Ctrl+D` — opens or creates today's note from anywhere

Step 1: Open today's daily note

Press `Ctrl+D`. If today's note doesn't exist, Obsidian creates it automatically and Templater applies the Daily Note Template.

If the note already exists: It opens directly. Scroll to wherever you are in the workflow.

Step 2: Morning — write your focus intention (2 min)

What it is: One sentence that answers: "What would make today a win?" This is not a task list — it's an intention. One thing that, if it happened, would make the day feel worthwhile.

How to do it:

1. Open today's note (`Ctrl+D`)
2. Find the "Today's focus" section at the top
3. Click in the `>` blockquote after "Today's focus:"
4. Write one complete sentence. Examples:
 - "Complete the Powerflex 753 fault investigation and document the root cause."
 - "Get through Week 1 of the HAM Radio syllabus and hit >80% on HamStudy."
 - "Be fully present with the kids this evening."
5. Copy this sentence to the `focus_intention:` field in the Properties panel (⌘ icon at top of note)

Why copy it to frontmatter: The `focus_intention:` field feeds the `daily-focus.base` view on the dashboard and in every review. This is what shows your planned vs. actual pattern over time.

Step 3: Morning — check quest habits

What it is: Three checkboxes at the top of the daily note corresponding to the Health Reset daily habits. Check the ones you've done or commit to the ones you'll do today.

How to do it:

1. Find the "Quest habits" section
 2. Three checkboxes:
 - ☐ Moved for 30+ min
 - ☐  In bed by target time
 - ☐ Avoided main dietary drain
 3. Check the boxes as you complete each habit during the day
 4. The Sunday weekly review Section 5 (Quest progress) will ask if the quest moved forward — having these checked is your evidence
-

Step 4: During the day — log focus sessions

What it is: Every time you complete a focused work session, log it in the Focus log section with the number of minutes. This builds the focus data that feeds the heatmap calendar and weekly reviews.

How to do it:

1. Find the "Focus log" section in the daily note
2. After each session, add a new line:

```
- [duration:: 90]
```

Replace 90 with the actual minutes.

3. The DataviewJS block above automatically calculates the running total and displays it.

Quick reference:

- 30 min = 30
- 1 hour = 60
- 90 min = 90
- 2 hours = 120
- 2.5 hours = 150

For multi-session days: Add one line per session. Each line is one block of focused work.

Step 5: Evening — copy focus total to frontmatter

What it is: The `focus_minutes:` frontmatter field is what the dashboard, weekly reviews, and heatmap calendar read. It must be a number, not a formula.

The fast way (recommended):

1. At end of day, press `Ctrl+Shift+M` (if hotkey assigned) OR `Ctrl+P` → "Update Focus Minutes"
2. The Templater script reads all `[duration:: N]` entries, sums them, and writes the total to `focus_minutes:` automatically
3. A notification confirms: "☐ focus_minutes updated → 9h 45m (585 min)"

The manual way:

1. Look at "Focus total" in the Focus log section — note the number
 2. Open the Properties panel (⌘ icon)
 3. Find `focus_minutes:` and type the number
-

Step 6: Evening — log vitals

What it is: Health measurements entered into the note's frontmatter. The vitals tracker on the dashboard reads these fields and produces daily logs, weekly averages, monthly averages, and color-coded status indicators.

How to do it:

1. Open the Properties panel (⌘ icon at the top of the note)
2. Find and fill in the fields you measured today:

| Field | What to enter | When to measure |
|------------------------------|--|--|
| <code>bp_systolic</code> | Top number of BP (e.g., 118) | Morning, before activity |
| <code>bp_diastolic</code> | Bottom number of BP (e.g., 76) | Same time as systolic |
| <code>pulse</code> | Heart rate in BPM (e.g., 68) | Same time as BP |
| <code>glucose</code> | Fasting blood glucose mg/dL (e.g., 95) | Before breakfast |
| <code>glucose_context</code> | Text tag if reading is unusual | When glucose is affected by medication/illness |
| <code>weight</code> | Body weight in lbs (e.g., 326.4) | Morning, after bathroom, before eating |
| <code>steps</code> | Total steps for the day (e.g., 3758) | End of day from watch/phone |
| <code>energy</code> | Subjective energy 1-5 (e.g., 3) | End of day — how you felt overall |

You don't need to measure everything every day. Leave any field blank on days you skip it. Blank days are invisible to the tracker — they don't pollute averages.

The `glucose_context` field: Use plain text tags like `steroid-affected`, `post-meal`, `ill`, `exercise-affected`. This appears as a ⚠ flag in the weekly review vitals table so you remember why an unusual reading occurred.

The `energy` field: This is the most important and easiest to forget. It takes 5 seconds. Rate your overall energy for the day 1-5: 1 = depleted, 3 = functional, 5 = excellent. Enter it before closing Obsidian for the day.

Step 7: Evening — write the end-of-day note

What it is: One honest sentence about what actually happened today. Not a report. Not a summary. One sentence that captures the truth of the day.

How to do it:

1. Find the "End-of-day note" section at the bottom of the daily note

2. Click in the `>` blockquote
3. Write one sentence. Examples:
 - "Got the Powerflex sorted — overcurrent on ramp-up, extended the accel time and it cleared."
 - "HAM study went well, G1 sections done, hit 84% on HamStudy."
 - "Didn't make it to the gym — back was hurting, took a walk instead."
4. Copy this sentence to the `end_of_day:` field in the Properties panel

Why copy to frontmatter: Same reason as `focus_intention:` — it feeds the `daily-focus.base` view and appears in all reviews as the "what actually happened" column alongside your morning intention.

Part 2: The Weekly Review

What it is

The weekly review is the most important recurring event in the system. It's where the data collected during the week becomes meaning. Without the weekly review, daily notes are just records. With it, they become pattern recognition.

When: Every Sunday. Budget 20-30 minutes minimum.

How to create: `Ctrl+Shift+W` — creates the weekly review note in `03-Reviews/Weekly/` with filename `YYYY-WXX`

Section 1: Clear the decks (5 min)

Purpose: Empty all inboxes so the review starts with a clean mind.

How to do it:

1. Process email/messages to zero — reply, delegate, or file. Don't leave anything unread.
 2. Review calendar — look at last week and confirm everything that needed follow-up got it. Look at next week and confirm there's nothing you need to prepare for.
 3. Sweep Todoist inbox — go to `todoist://inbox`. Every item gets a project and a date, or gets deleted. Nothing stays in the inbox.
 4. File loose notes — any browser tabs, sticky notes, or paper notes that haven't been captured. Either put them in Obsidian (fleeting note) or Todoist (task) or throw them away.
-

Section 1b: This week's calendar

Purpose: Create a record of what was actually on your calendar this week, and compare it to what actually happened.

How to do it:

1. Press `Ctrl+Shift+K` to refresh the Weekly Calendar note
 2. Open `00-Home/Weekly Calendar.md`
 3. Select all (`Ctrl+A`) and copy (`Ctrl+C`)
 4. Paste into the "Planned week" collapsed section
 5. After pasting, expand the "Planned vs. actual" section and write 2-3 sentences: what shifted, what got added, what surprised you
-

Section 2: Life area check-in

Purpose: Rate your week across the same 6 life areas as the Life Compass energy audit. This builds weekly data that feeds monthly and quarterly trend analysis.

How to do it:

1. Rate each of the 6 areas 1-5 based on how the week *felt*:
 - Work & career
 - Health & energy
 - Relationships
 - Personal growth
 - Fun & creativity
 - Money & finances
2. Add a one-word note for each (e.g., "productive", "depleted", "steady")
3. Calculate your overall week rating: this can be an average of the 6 scores, or just your gut feel for the week
4. **Critical step:** Copy the overall rating number to `rating:` in the Properties panel (⌘ icon)

Why the frontmatter matters: The `rating:` field is what the dashboard's "Recent weekly reviews" base reads. Without it, the dashboard shows nothing.

The Health & energy vitals table: This section includes a Dataview table that auto-populates your daily vitals for the week. It just works — no action needed. But if it shows dashes across the board, check that you've been entering vitals in your daily notes.

Section 3: Focus hours

Purpose: Total your focus time for the week and connect it to the review record.

How to do it:

1. Add up the `focus_minutes:` values from each daily note this week. The Dataview table in this section may show them automatically.
2. Write the total at the top of the section: "Total this week: 540 min (9h 0m)"
3. **Critical step:** Copy the total minutes to `focus_minutes:` in the Properties panel
4. Fill in the day-by-day breakdown table if useful — it only takes a minute and shows the shape of your week

The 1,200 min / 20 hr weekly target is a suggested baseline. Track the trend, not just the number.

Section 4: Three wins this week

Purpose: Identify what actually went well. This is harder than it sounds — most people default to what went wrong. Force yourself to find three genuine wins, however small.

How to do it:

1. Look at your daily notes' `focus_intention:` entries for the week — what did you set out to do?
2. Look at your `end_of_day:` entries — what actually happened that was good?
3. Look at your quest habits checkboxes — how many days did you hit all three?
4. Write three wins. They don't need to be impressive. "Finished the Powerflex documentation" is a win. "Went to bed by 10pm four nights" is a win.

The `daily-focus.base` embedded in this section shows your intentions and reflections side by side. This is your raw material for identifying wins.

Section 5: Quest progress

Purpose: Check whether your quests moved forward this week and update the progress numbers in the quest notes.

How to do it:

1. The Dataview table shows all active quests with their current progress percentage and health indicator (▢▢▢)
2. For each quest in the manual table below it, answer:
 - Did it move forward? What specifically happened?
 - Was it blocked? What blocked it?

3. **After filling in the table:** Open each quest note that made progress
4. In the quest note Properties panel, update `progress:` (the number 0–100)
5. Each quest's milestones are worth 25 points each when fully complete

Current quests:

- Health Reset Q3: open `02-Quests/Health-Reset-Q3-2026.md` → update `progress:`
 - New Role Integration Q3: open `02-Quests/New-Role-Integration-Q3-2026.md` → update `progress:`
-

Section 6: Reflection prompts

Purpose: Answer 2–3 questions honestly without editing. These are for you, not for an audience.

How to do it:

1. Read each prompt
2. Pick 2–3 that feel most relevant to this specific week
3. Write the first true answer that comes to mind. Don't polish it.

The prompts:

- "What drained my energy most this week?" — look for patterns across multiple weeks
 - "What gave me the most energy?" — these are signals about what to do more of
 - "Did I spend time on what actually matters to me?" — honest answer
 - "Stop / start / continue" — one thing to stop doing, one to start, one to keep
 - "Did I act in line with my core values?" — reference your Life Compass
 - "One thing I'm grateful for" — anchor the review in something positive
-

Section 7: Next week intention

Purpose: Set the direction for next week before it starts, not during it.

How to do it:

1. Write one sentence: "Next week I want to..." — an intention, not a task list
 2. Write 3 specific priorities — things that, if completed, would make next week a success. Be specific enough that you'll know Sunday whether they happened.
 3. Open Morgen Calendar: block time for your 3 priorities. If you don't block it, it won't happen.
 4. Press `ctrl+Shift+J` to fetch next week's calendar. Review the blocks.
 5. Under "One quest milestone I will complete:" — name the specific milestone, not just the quest.
-

Section 8: Zettelkasten inbox

Purpose: Process the Zettelkasten's fleeting inbox and write 2-3 permanent notes.

How to do it: See the full Zettelkasten Procedure document, Part 5 (Weekly Processing Workflow). In brief:

1. Open `06-Zettelkasten/06-Zettelkasten.md`
 2. Work through fleeting notes oldest-first — process or delete each one
 3. Open the Literature Processing Guide → pick the top Tier 1 claim
 4. Write 2-3 permanent notes using `Ctrl+Shift+P`
 5. Check the review queue — add at least one link to an old permanent note
-

Section 9: Capture anything else

Purpose: Brain dump anything that didn't fit the other sections.

How to do it: Write anything still on your mind. Questions, observations, ideas, things to research, things to say to people. Get them out of your head and into the note. Process anything actionable into Todoist after the review.

After the weekly review: Quest-Todoist sync (5 min)

After completing the review:

1. Look at your quest milestones — did any complete this week?
 2. If yes: create the next milestone's key action in Todoist with a due date
 - Health Reset milestones → Personal project
 - New Role Integration milestones → Work project
 3. This ensures quest milestones have real Todoist tasks driving them, not just checklist items in a note
-

Part 3: The Monthly Review

What it is

The monthly review zooms out from the weekly tactical level to the strategic level. It's where you check whether the month's activity added up to progress on what matters. Budget 30-45 minutes.

When: Last Sunday of each month.

How to create: Dashboard → "New monthly review" link, OR `Ctrl+P` → "Periodic Notes: Open Monthly Note"

Section 1: Clear and capture (5 min)

Read back through ALL weekly reviews from the month first. This takes 10–15 minutes but is essential — the monthly review should synthesize the weekly reviews, not duplicate them.

Then:

1. Collect any loose tasks or ideas still floating
 2. Check calendar for next month — anything to plan ahead?
-

Section 2: Month in numbers

How to fill it in:

1. **Focus time total:** Sum all `focus_minutes:` from each weekly review, or add up all daily notes. Copy the total to `focus_minutes_total:` in Properties.
2. **Weekly reviews completed:** Count how many of the 4–5 Sundays this month had completed reviews with a rating. Note the count (e.g., "3/4")
3. **Quest milestones hit:** Count milestones completed this month across both quests
4. **Books finished:** Any books whose status changed to `done` this month
5. **Overall month rating:** 1–5 gut feel for how the month went. Copy to `rating:` in Properties.

The Dataview table in this section auto-populates each week's rating and focus hours — this is your summary at a glance.

Section 3: Life area check-in

How to fill it in:

1. Rate all 6 life areas 1–5 for the month as a whole (not just the most recent week)
 2. For each area, note the direction: ↑ (better than last month), → (same), or ↓ (worse)
 3. Write the key insight — not a judgment, an observation. "Started Argenta, still learning the ropes" not "work is hard."
 4. Answer: Which area improved most? Which needs most attention next month?
-

Section 4: Quest progress

The Dataview table shows live quest status. The manual table below it is where you write context:

- What actually moved the quest forward?
 - What blocked it?
 - Is any quest at risk of not completing by Q3?
-

Sections 5-10

Section 5 (Wins): Pull 3-5 things worth remembering from the month. Pull from your weekly reviews' "three wins" sections.

Section 6 (What drained me): Patterns across the month. If the same thing drained you 3 weeks in a row, it's not a bad week — it's a structural problem.

Section 7 (Values check): Re-read your Life Compass values. For each one, write how you lived it and where you fell short this month. One honest sentence each.

Section 8 (Learning and growth): Best book/article/video. Most useful insight. Skill to develop next month.

Section 9 (Next month intention): One sentence intention for next month. Three focus areas. One quest that must move significantly. One relationship to invest in. One habit to build or break.

Section 10 (Anything else): Ideas and observations to revisit at the quarterly review.

Part 4: The Quarterly Review

What it is

The quarterly review is the most important review in the system. It's where you look at 90 days of data, decide whether your quests were the right ones, update your Life Compass, and design next quarter. Budget 60-90 minutes. Do not rush it.

When: Last Sunday of the quarter (late September for Q3 2026).

How to create: Dashboard → "New quarterly review" link

Before starting, read back through:

- All weekly reviews from the quarter
- All monthly reviews from the quarter

- Every quest note
- Your Life Compass
- Your Future Vision

This reading takes 20-30 minutes and is not optional. The quarterly review synthesizes 90 days of data — you can't synthesize what you haven't read.

The 14 sections (overview)

The quarterly review template has 14 sections. Here's what to do with each:

Section 1 — Set the scene: Note where you are and how you feel. Confirm you've read back through everything. This is the moment to shift from the daily operational mode to the strategic reflective mode.

Section 2 — Quarter in numbers: The Dataview table auto-populates all weekly data. Fill in the summary metrics manually (total focus hours, average weekly rating, quests completed, books finished). Copy `focus_hours_total` and quest counts to frontmatter.

Section 3 — Quest retrospective: For each quest that ran this quarter, answer: What was the outcome? What moved it most? What blocked it? What would you do differently? There's one section per quest — be honest and specific.

Section 4 — Life area deep-dive: Rate all 6 areas for the quarter as a whole, note the trend vs. last quarter, and identify the biggest win and biggest gap in each area.

Section 5 — Ten wins: Force yourself to find 10 wins from the quarter. Pull from your weekly and monthly reviews. Include small ones — this is a comprehensive accounting, not a highlight reel.

Section 6 — What drained me most: Not week-to-week variation — patterns that persisted all quarter. What kept coming up? What should you have exited earlier?

Section 7 — Values and identity check: Re-read your Life Compass before answering. For each value: evidence you lived it, where you fell short. Then: who did you show up as this quarter? Is the Life Compass still accurate? If values or roles need updating, do it now.

Section 8 — Vision check: Re-read Future Vision. Are you moving toward your 1-year vision? What's the gap? Does the Future Vision need minor tweaks, major revision, or is it still accurate?

Section 9 — Learning and growth: Most impactful source this quarter. Single most useful insight to carry forward. Skill developed. Skill gap to address next quarter.

Section 10 — Relationships: Who showed up for you? Who to invest in next quarter?

Section 11 — What to let go: Habits, beliefs, commitments, obligations that no longer serve you. The quarterly review is the right moment to formally let go of things that aren't working.

Section 12 — The quarter in one paragraph: Force synthesis. Write one paragraph that captures the quarter as a whole. This paragraph will matter when you read it a year from now.

Section 13 — Score and close: Overall rating /10. One word that captures the quarter. One thing most proud of. One thing to change next quarter.

Section 14 — Ready for next quarter? Checklist: review complete, Life Compass updated, Future Vision updated, Quarterly Planning session scheduled.

After the quarterly review: Quarterly Planning

Immediately after completing the review, run a Quarterly Planning session using the Quarterly Planning Template (linked at the bottom of the review).

How to do it:

1. `Ctrl+P` → "Templater: Create new note from template" → "Quarterly Planning Template"
 2. Based on the quarterly review, design 1-3 quests for next quarter
 3. For each quest: create the quest note using `Ctrl+P` → "New Quest" from the dashboard
 4. For each quest's first milestone: create a Todoist task with a due date
 5. Update the calendar: book monthly review Sundays, the next quarterly review date, and any critical deadline blocks
-

Part 5: Quest Management

Creating a quest

When: At each quarterly planning session, or when a significant new commitment warrants a dedicated 90-day focus.

How to do it:

1. From the dashboard, click "New quest" OR navigate to `02-Quests/` and create a new note (Templater applies the Quest Template)
 2. **Immediately rename** the file (`F2`) to a descriptive name with the quarter: `Health-Reset-Q3-2026`. The filename drives the "Weekly actions" task query inside the quest note — it must be exact.
 3. Fill in frontmatter fields via the Properties panel:
 - `area:` — Work / Health / Relationships / Growth / Fun / Finance
 - `quarter:` — format `Q3-2026`
 - `due:` — end of the quarter
 - `progress:` — starts at 0
 - `status:` — Active
 4. Fill in the four key sections:
 - **Why this quest:** One sentence connecting to Life Compass or Future Vision. If you can't write this sentence, reconsider the quest.
 - **Definition of done:** Specific and measurable. "Get healthier" is not a definition of done.
 - **Milestones:** 3-4 checkpoints across 12 weeks. Each should represent roughly 25 points of progress.
 - **What I'll say no to:** Explicitly name what you're de-prioritizing to make space.
 5. Add a recurring Todoist task: "Update quest progress in Obsidian" → every Sunday, Personal project
-

Updating quest progress

When: Every Sunday during the weekly review, after completing Section 5.

How to do it:

1. Open the quest note
2. Open the Properties panel (⌘ icon)
3. Find `progress:` — update the number (0-100)
4. Each top-level milestone completed = 25 points
5. Partial progress within a milestone is at your discretion — be honest

Progress → Health indicator mapping:

- $\geq 66\%$ → ☐ On track
- 33-65% → ☐ Check in
- $< 33\%$ → ☐ At risk

The health indicator compares progress to time elapsed in the quarter, so a quest at 40% in week 8 is behind even though it's not at 0%.

Completing or abandoning a quest

When completed:

1. Change `status:` from `Active` to `Completed` in Properties
2. Write a reflection in the Notes section of the quest note
3. Move the file to `_archive/Quests/` if you want to clean up the active quests view
4. At the quarterly review, include this quest in the retrospective

When abandoned (conscious decision to stop):

1. Change `status:` to `Abandoned`
 2. Write why you're stopping — this is more valuable than completed quests for understanding how you make decisions
 3. Archive it if desired
-

Part 6: Resource Management

Adding a book

When: When you start reading or want to track a book.

How to do it:

1. From dashboard → click "New book" OR navigate to `05-Resources/Books/` and create a new note
2. **Rename immediately** to the book title
3. Fill in Properties:
 - `author:`
 - `status:` — `to-read` / `reading` / `done`
 - `date_started:` — when you started
 - `date_finished:` — when you finish
 - `rating:` — 1-5 when done

The `status: reading` drives the "Currently reading" section on the dashboard. Only notes with this status appear there.

When you finish a book:

1. Change `status:` to `done`
2. Set `date_finished:` and `rating:`

3. Write or update the Literature note in `06-Zettelkasten/Literature/`
 4. In the book note's "Linked notes" section, add: `Title`
-

Adding an article

When: When you save an article from the web, a blog post, documentation, or any written piece you want to read or reference.

How to do it:

1. Navigate to `05-Resources/Articles/` and create a new note there (Templater applies the Article Template automatically), OR use `Ctrl+P` → "Templater: Create new note from template" → "Article Template"
2. **Rename immediately** to the article title
3. Fill in the Properties panel:
 - `url:` — the full URL of the article
 - `author:` — author name if known
 - `source:` — publication, website, or origin
 - `status:` — `to-read` when saving, `reading` when actively reading, `done` when finished
 - `date_saved:` — auto-filled by Templater with today's date
 - `date_read:` — fill in when you finish it

Filling in the article note body:

- **Why this is worth reading** — write one sentence about what you expect to get from it *before* reading
- **Key ideas** — write the key ideas in your own words (not copy-paste)
- **Quotes worth keeping** — 1-3 lines you'd actually re-read
- **My takeaway** — after finishing: what's the single most useful thing you're taking from this?

When you finish an article:

1. Change `status:` to `done`
2. Fill in `date_read:`
3. Write your takeaway section
4. If the article generated an insight worth keeping: create a literature note or permanent note and link it in the "Linked notes" section

The **Obsidian Web Clipper** browser extension (free, official — install at obsidian.md/clipper) can auto-fill the Article Template from any webpage with one click.

Recommended for quick saves without leaving the browser.

Adding a PDF to the vault

In brief:

1. **Drag the PDF** into any open Obsidian note — it saves to `_attachments/` automatically
 2. **Move it** to the correct subfolder in the file panel (`_attachments/Work/Automation/`, etc.)
 3. **Create a companion note** in the same subfolder using the Attachment Note Template. Name it identically to the PDF without the extension.
 4. **Fill in the Properties panel** of the companion note: `title`, `type: attachment`, `category`, `vendor`, `description`, `added`, `linked_note`
 5. The PDF appears in the Attachment Catalog automatically once the companion note is saved
-

Adding a troubleshooting log

When: Any time you work through a problem at Argenta — equipment fault, software issue, process anomaly.

How to do it:

1. Right-click `07-Work-Knowledge/Troubleshooting/` in the file panel → New note, OR press `Ctrl+Shift+T` (if hotkey assigned), OR `Ctrl+P` → "New Troubleshooting Log"
 2. Templater applies the Troubleshooting Log Template automatically
 3. **Name the file:** `YYYY-MM-DD - Equipment Description` (e.g., `2026-06-05 - CP12 Agitator Powerflex 753 Fault`)
 4. Fill in each section while the incident is fresh — especially Sections 1 (symptom), 4 (diagnostic steps), 5 (root cause), and 6 (fix applied)
 5. Update `status:` from `open` to `resolved` in Properties when the issue is closed
-

Adding notes to Work Knowledge

When: When you learn something at work from a manual, colleague, troubleshooting session, or training.

How to do it:

1. Navigate to the appropriate subfolder:
 - Electrical/PLC/protocols → `07-Work-Knowledge/Automation/`
 - Networks, servers, IT → `07-Work-Knowledge/Networking/`
 - Argenta processes, SOPs, pharma → `07-Work-Knowledge/Processes/`

- Equipment incidents → `07-Work-Knowledge/Troubleshooting/`
 - CAP exam prep → `07-Work-Knowledge/CAP-Certification/`
2. Create a new note there — start with a clear heading and write what you learned
 3. Link it to related notes using `note-name` syntax
 4. If the note relates to a specific PDF in `_attachments/Work/`, add a link to that PDF

Naming convention: Use descriptive names, not topic names. "Powerflex 753 overcurrent fault during ramp-up" is better than "VFD faults."

Part 7: The Three-Tool System

How the tools divide responsibilities

| Tool | Owns | Does NOT own |
|------------------------|--|--|
| Obsidian vault | Intention, reflection, quest management, knowledge, vitals, reviews | Task management with reminders, scheduling |
| Todoist | All actionable tasks with due dates; quick capture; reminders; notifications | Reflection, knowledge, long-form thinking |
| Morgen Calendar | Time-bound events; time-blocking; the daily schedule view | Task management, note-taking |

The key rule: If something needs to happen by a certain time, it's in Todoist. If it needs to be reflected on or built upon, it's in Obsidian. If it needs a time slot on the calendar, it's in Morgen.

The morning sequence (do these in order)

Step 1 — Morgen Calendar first (3 min)

Open Morgen before anything else. See the shape of the day: what meetings are fixed? How much unstructured time actually exists? Planning a full task day and then losing it to meetings is the most common morning mistake.

Step 2 — Todoist Today view (5 min)

Open `todoist://today`. Given what you just saw in Morgen:

- Are today's tasks realistic?
- Reschedule anything that won't happen
- Process any overnight inbox items (assign project + date — 2 min max each)
- Identify your 1-2 most important tasks

Step 3 — Obsidian daily note (5 min)

Now open today's note (`Ctrl+D`) and write your focus intention — informed by steps 1 and 2. Also check quest habits and morning vitals.

Step 4 — Morgen time-block (2 min)

Back to Morgen: if any Todoist priorities need protected time, block it now. Not "I'll find time" — block it.

Capture routing during the day

When something surfaces, route it immediately:

| What surfaced | Where it goes |
|---|--|
| Work task with a deadline | Todoist → Work project |
| Personal task or errand | Todoist → Personal project |
| Anything in your head that's not a task | <code>Ctrl+Shift+C</code> → daily note capture (no context switch) |
| Insight or idea worth developing | <code>Ctrl+Shift+F</code> → Fleeting note |
| Quest-related action | Task in the quest note: <code>- [] Action ▢ YYYY-MM-DD</code> |
| Meeting to schedule | Morgen Calendar directly |

The rule: Anything with a due date and a reminder goes in Todoist. Everything else goes in Obsidian.

The weekly calendar script

What it does: Fetches your Google Calendar (and Todoist via iCal) for the week and writes a formatted markdown note.

Hotkeys:

- `Ctrl+Shift+K` → fetches current week → writes to `00-Home/Weekly Calendar.md`
- `Ctrl+Shift+J` → fetches next week → writes to `00-Home/Next Week Calendar.md`

After fetching:

1. Open `00-Home/Weekly Calendar.md`
2. Select all (`Ctrl+A`) and copy (`Ctrl+C`)
3. Paste into the weekly review Section 1b "Planned week" section

If Todoist tasks don't appear: Confirm you've added your Todoist iCal URL in QuickAdd settings (Settings → QuickAdd → Manage Macros → Weekly Calendar → ⚙ gear → `todoist_ics_url`). Todoist tasks appear with a `T` prefix to distinguish them from calendar events.

Part 8: The Backup System

How it works

The vault uses two-layer backup:

Layer 1 — Git (version history): Every hour (via Task Scheduler), the vault auto-commits to a private GitHub repository at `github.com/glpelletier-jpg/slip-box-vault`. Full history — you can roll back any note to any point in time.

Layer 2 — OneDrive (continuous sync): Real-time cloud copy. If your laptop dies, the vault is accessible immediately from any device via OneDrive.

Running a manual backup

Double-click `_scripts/vault-backup.bat` in File Explorer, or open Command Prompt and run:

```
"C:\Vault\Slip Box\_scripts\vault-backup.bat"
```

A log is written to `C:\Vault\backup-log.txt` confirming what was committed and pushed.

Verifying the backup is working

1. Open `C:\Vault\backup-log.txt` — look for recent timestamps
2. OR: go to `github.com/glpelletier-jpg/slip-box-vault` in a browser — you should see commits from today

Recovery scenarios

| Problem | Recovery method |
|-----------------------------|---|
| Accidentally deleted a note | <code>Ctrl+P</code> → "File Recovery: Open file recovery" → find the note → Restore |
| Corrupted note | Same as above — File Recovery keeps snapshots |

| Problem | Recovery method |
|-----------------------------------|--|
| Entire vault deleted or corrupted | Open Command Prompt → <code>git clone https://github.com/glpelletier-jpg/slip-box-vault.git "C:\Vault\Slip Box"</code> |
| New laptop | Install Git and Obsidian → clone the GitHub repo → open vault |

Full backup documentation: Vault Backup System

Quick reference: all hotkeys

| Action | Hotkey |
|-----------------------------------|---|
| Open today's daily note | <code>Ctrl+D</code> |
| Open this week's review | <code>Ctrl+Shift+W</code> |
| Open dashboard | <code>Ctrl+H</code> |
| New fleeting note | <code>Ctrl+Shift+F</code> |
| Quick capture (no context switch) | <code>Ctrl+Shift+C</code> |
| New permanent note | <code>Ctrl+Shift+P</code> |
| New troubleshooting log | <code>Ctrl+Shift+T</code> <i>(assign in QuickAdd)</i> |
| Fetch weekly calendar | <code>Ctrl+Shift+K</code> |
| Fetch next week calendar | <code>Ctrl+Shift+J</code> |
| Open graph view | <code>Ctrl+G</code> |
| Open command palette | <code>Ctrl+P</code> |

Links: Life Compass Procedure | Zettelkasten Procedure | Master Guide | Dashboard

Vault State — June 2026

Vault State — June 2026

Living snapshot. Update "what needs attention" after each weekly review.

Stats (June 8, 2026)

| Area | Count | Notes |
|----------------------|------------|--|
| Total notes | ~460 | All folders |
| Daily notes | 19 | May 21 – Jun 8 · all filled |
| Focus minutes logged | All 19 | Strong habit — vitals + energy filled every day |
| Weekly reviews | 4 | W20-W23 complete |
| Monthly reviews | 2 | May (partial) · June (fill at month end) |
| Active quests | 2 | Health Reset (15%) · New Role Integration (10%) |
| Life Compass | □ Complete | All values, roles, energy audit filled |
| Literature notes | 49 | 38 original + 11 IA/OT reference stubs (June 2026) |
| Permanent notes | 28 | 6 original + 22 IA/OT domain stubs (June 2026) |
| MOCs | 8 | Automation · HAM · PKM · Personal Growth · Instrumentation · OT Networking · PLC Architecture · Process Safety |
| Fleeting notes | ~150 | □ Critical backlog — triage 10/week, target <50 by Q3 end |
| Work Knowledge | 38 notes | 5 subfolders populated |
| Attachments | | Rockwell PDFs + HAM Radio resources |

| Area | Count | Notes |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------|---|
| | 17 companion notes | |
| Git backup | ☐ Active | Remote: github.com/glpelletier-jpg/slip-box-vault · current as of Jun 9 |
| Community plugins | 15 | All enabled |
| Commander | ☐ Configured | Ribbon + Toolbar wired, all buttons working (mode: any) |
| Dashboard | ☐ Live | Base file transclusions — all panels populate |
| Templates | 18 | Including Automation-Permanent and Automation-Literature templates |
| Evaluations | 14 | Full audit history in <code>_docs/Evaluations/</code> |

What's active right now

Quests

- Health Reset Q3 — 15% · 3 daily habits active · tracking in daily notes
- New Role Integration Q3 — 10% · Learning systems · Primary automation engineer at Argenta as of Jun 5

Study

- **HAM Radio General License** — started Jun 8, Week 1: G1 Commission's Rules
- Open General License Syllabus for week-by-week schedule

Permanent note stubs to fill

- 22 IA/OT stubs in `06-Zettelkasten/Permanent/` — each has a Claim and empty body sections
- Fill 1 per week from the stub's Claim: write Explanation, Evidence, Conditions, Cross-links

What's working well

- **Daily schedule in daily notes** — `_scripts/daily-schedule.js` auto-populates Google Calendar events on note creation
- **Commander toolbar** — Dashboard, Today's Note, Weekly Review, New Permanent Note, New Troubleshooting Log, Daily Capture — all one-click, all buttons have `mode: any`
- **Daily note system** — 19/19 days complete with vitals, focus log, habits, tasks, and end-of-day reflection
- **Dashboard** — live base views for quests, vitals, focus, Zettelkasten, reviews
- **Git backup** — restored and pushed Jun 9 after repo re-initialization
- **Work Knowledge** — 38 notes across 5 subfolders, 4 automation-domain MOCs fully linked
- **Documentation** — consolidated into single Master Guide; `_docs/` fully restored

What needs attention

| Priority | Item | Action |
|----------|---------------------------------------|--|
| □ 1 | Fleeting notes backlog (~150) | Triage 10/week during Sunday review — process or delete |
| □ 2 | Fill PN stub Explanation sections | 1 per week — open the stub, write Explanation + Evidence + Cross-links |
| □ 3 | Fill LIT stub summaries | 11 new IA/OT literature stubs need Summary + Key concepts |
| □ 4 | <code>_reference/Work</code> is empty | Add contacts, site access notes, credential hints, SOPs |
| □ 5 | June monthly review | Fill at month end — template is ready |
| □ 6 | Quarterly planning (Q3) | After June monthly review — design Q3 quest milestones |

Bugs fixed (history)

June 8, 2026

- `_docs/` folder lost during git re-initialization — restored from commit `355ae7f` via `git show`.

- `index.lock` **blocking git** — caused by Obsidian Git plugin holding lock. Resolved by deleting lock file and re-running `vault-backup.bat`.
- **Git .git/ folder missing** — accidentally deleted when clearing `index.lock`. Restored via `git init` + `git reset origin/master` + push.

June 6-8, 2026

- **28 missing PN permanent note stubs** — created in `06-Zettelkasten/Permanent/` across 4 domains (Instrumentation, PLC Architecture, OT Networking, Process Safety). MOC links updated to use `-` for Windows-safe filenames.
- **11 missing LIT literature note stubs** — created in `06-Zettelkasten/Literature/` for key IA/OT standards and vendor references.
- `focus_hours` **Dataview field bug** — Monthly review (2026-06.md) and Quarterly review (2026-Q2-review.md) used `focus_hours` instead of `focus_minutes`. Fixed in both files.

June 5-6, 2026

- **Commander buttons** — wrong `id` (UUID vs command ID), missing `mode: "any"`. All fixed.
- **Dashboard missing** — `00-Home/00-Home.md` recreated with `.base` transclusions.
- `steps:` **quoted as strings** — fixed: `force-yaml-escape` disabled in Linter.

Commander quick reference

| Button | What it does | Where it appears |
|---------------------------|---|-------------------|
| □ Dashboard | Opens 00-Home dashboard | Left Ribbon |
| □ Today's Note | Opens or creates today's daily note | Toolbar + Tab Bar |
| □ Weekly Review | Opens this week's review | Toolbar + Tab Bar |
| □ New Permanent Note | QuickAdd → new permanent note template | Toolbar + Tab Bar |
| □ New Troubleshooting Log | QuickAdd → new troubleshooting log template | Toolbar + Tab Bar |
| □ Daily Capture | QuickAdd → append to today's capture inbox | Toolbar + Tab Bar |

Tab Bar requires Settings → Appearance → Show tab title bar = ON

Monthly health check queries

Run these on the first Sunday of each month. Open a note and paste the query — or build it into a Vault State template.

Orphan detector — notes with no backlinks:

```
TABLE file.path AS Path
FROM "" WHERE length(file.inlinks) = 0 AND file.folder != "_docs" AND file.folder !=
_templates"
SORT file.mtime DESC
LIMIT 20
```

Fleeting inbox count:

```
TABLE length(rows) AS "Count" FROM "06-Zettelkasten/Fleeting" GROUP BY true
```

Permanent notes without outlinks (< 2):

```
TABLE length(file.outlinks) AS "Outlinks"
FROM "06-Zettelkasten/Permanent"
WHERE length(file.outlinks) < 2
```

Quarterly audit queries

Fleeting notes processed this quarter (tagged `processed`):

```
TABLE file.name FROM "06-Zettelkasten/Fleeting" WHERE contains(tags, "processed")
```

Work Knowledge coverage by subfolder:

```
TABLE length(rows) AS "Notes"
FROM "07-Work-Knowledge"
GROUP BY file.folder
```

CAP exam prep notes:

```
TABLE file.name, file.mtime AS "Last edited"  
FROM "" WHERE contains(tags, "CAP-prep")  
SORT file.mtime DESC
```

HAM Radio study progress:

```
TABLE file.name, file.mtime AS "Last edited"  
FROM "05-Resources/Courses/HAM-Radio"  
SORT file.mtime DESC
```

Links: [Dashboard](#) | [Master Guide](#)